

SELJUK

Byzantium
Besieged
1068–1071



PLAYBOOK

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STRATEGY NOTES

From the Designer

The asymmetry of *SELJUK* is one of its core tenets, and playing well means dictating the terms and pace of the game such that your opponent is reacting to you and not the other way around. Efficiency is also of paramount importance; keeping your armies fed and making the most of their activations will determine victory and defeat.

To that end, here are some tips for playing each side:

Romans

Your forces are more resilient in combat and if they can survive the initial volley of Seljuk archery, can cause serious damage to their horsemen in melee. Consider using your units as the Romans did historically: the infantry are there to absorb punishment and support the cavalry. Roman *tagmata* are great all-around units and you'll want to preserve them for each round of battle as much as possible.

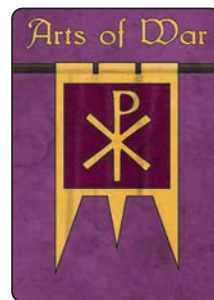
Each winter the Roman army will return to Constantinople, meaning marshalling your forces involves marching across Anatolia each year to the front. Your frontier Lords, Chatatourios and Robert Crépin, are weak on their own but can become more powerful over time if you make sure they can muster Capabilities or Vassals every turn. Robert's Norman Knights can eliminate a Seljuk army with a timely ambush card even when outnumbered.

Don't try to be everywhere at once, that is playing into the Seljuk player's hands. Instead, make good use of Romanos' ability to March with other Lords. Assemble larger armies to bully Seljuk raiders into parts of the map where they cannot Ravage effectively. You'll also need to know when to fight and when to retreat; attempting to brute force your way into a hive of Seljuk archery will surely lead to defeat.

Your *themata* are versatile units that can be used offensively or defensively, but are most valuable for the latter. If you commit too heavily with them and they're defeated, you make the Seljuk player's job easier in the following years.

Even if the Seljuk player makes gains in 1068, the campaign is long and there will be time to recover. It can't usually be won in the first year but it can definitely be lost.

Finally, pick your moments to go on offense opportunistically. You'll have to conquer a few strongholds to win the game, and a well-timed Strategic Objective can boost your gains.



Seljuks

Seljuk Lords come in two broad archetypes: agile raiding parties and heavier organized troops better suited for battle. Armies with only Turkic horses are fast and also deadly when defending. Use this double threat to your advantage by making the Roman player play whack-a-mole against you. Clever maneuvering can force the Roman player to guess where you're going next while you stay one step ahead.

Ravage early and ravage often, even if you have to use a single command. There's a 50/50 chance you'll remove defending *themata* units from play, which opens up new avenues of attack and conquest in future campaigns. If you feel you're not going to reach your Unity objective for the year, focus on mitigating the VP loss by setting yourself up to return Loot. Your Lords only have to make it back to a space adjacent to their Seat, and the MARWANID ALLIANCE Capability can make that job much easier.

Only attack if you greatly outnumber the enemy or you have a Hold card that can turn the tables; your Turkic Horse are weakest when they have to weather opposing defensive fire.

Going for the auto-win at Aleppo can be tempting, but it also telegraphs your plans to the Roman player, and while you're occupied, they can undo your hard-earned gains by striking into your territory (so be certain you're going to succeed).

Don't be afraid to let Lords Disband and bring them back later, especially if they've penetrated deep into Roman territory on a raiding mission. Their lower Service ratings mean they're harder to keep on the map but can return quickly.

Lastly, while Conquering Strongholds doesn't grant you VP, it can be useful to create choke points against Roman movement and also for Muster. If you don't think you can hold the location, Ruin it instead to score much more enduring ½ VP.





The Roman player now randomly draws their two Arts of War cards and gets SCHOLAI and ARMENIAN GARRISONS.

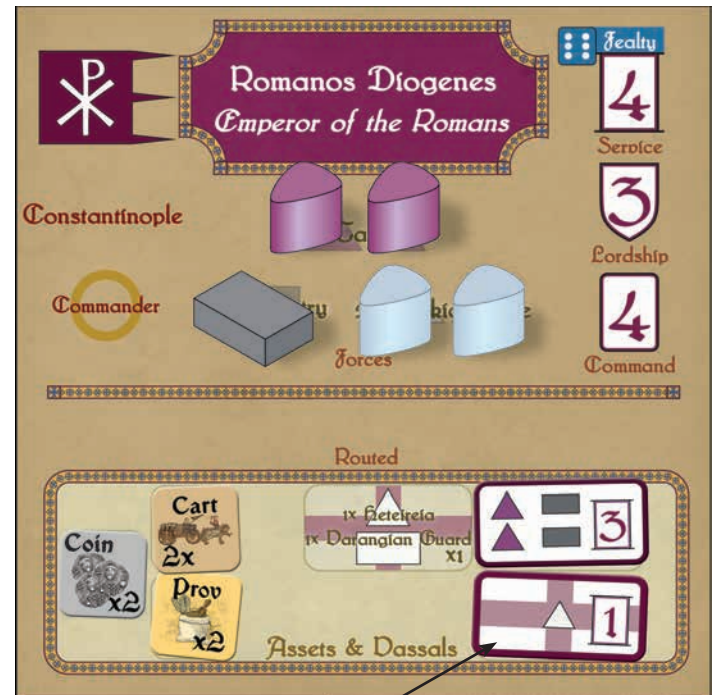


Roman Art of War card
#17 SCHOLAI



Roman Art of War card
#16 ARMENIAN GARRISONS

The Roman player tucks SCHOLAI under Romanos Diogenes' mat and adds the special Vassal marker to Romanos' Assets area (it does not automatically Muster the units). ARMENIAN GARRISONS will come in handy if the Romans can Conquer a Seljuk Stronghold. Because it is an "ALL" Capability, the Roman player must tuck it under the edge of the board. Board edge Capabilities take effect immediately upon being placed under the board.



The Scholai Service Marker has just been added.

In future turns, both players will implement the top half of the Arts of War cards for their random Events during this phase.

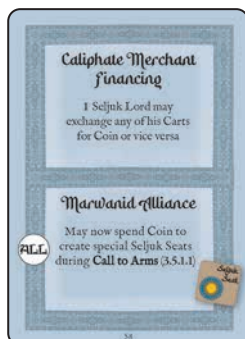
Examples of Play Scenario Setup and Gameplay

Set up the game according to the 1068 "Emperor and the Lion" scenario. Please refer to page 27 of the *SELJUK* rules for an illustration showing the starting positions of units for this scenario.

Both players shuffle their Arts of War decks. As this is the first turn of a scenario, both players, Seljuk first, begin by drawing two cards and implementing the bottom half of each (Capability).

Arts of War

The Seljuk player draws MARWANID ALLIANCE and ARTUKID LEGACY; they place the first under the edge of the board because it is an "ALL" Capability. Artuk Beg's cylinder is on the Calendar and not yet in the game, so the other card cannot be used and is returned to the Arts of War deck with no effect.



Seljuk Art of War card
#8 MARWANID ALLIANCE



Seljuk Art of War card
#10 ARTUKID LEGACY

Pay

Both players now move to the Pay phase. First the Seljuks have the option to pay Coin to their Lords to extend their Service. Neither Ibn Khan nor Arisighi have any Coin to be able to extend their own Service. However, as a Commander (indicated by his taller cylinder and the symbol on his mat) on the map, Alp Arslan is allowed to pay Coin from the Assets area of his Lord mat for any Unbesieged Seljuk Lords, regardless of how far away he is. The Seljuk player decides to spend one Coin from Alp Arslan's mat on Ibn Khan, moving Ibn Khan's Service marker forward from the Autumn 1068 box on the calendar to the Spring 1069 box.

The Roman player declines to Pay any of their Lords.

Disband

Looking at the calendar, if any Lord's Service marker was in the current Calendar box or earlier than the turn marker, then those Lords would Disband and be placed on the Calendar (if on the current turn box) or removed from the game (if left of the current turn box). In Spring 1068, no such Lord meets these criteria.

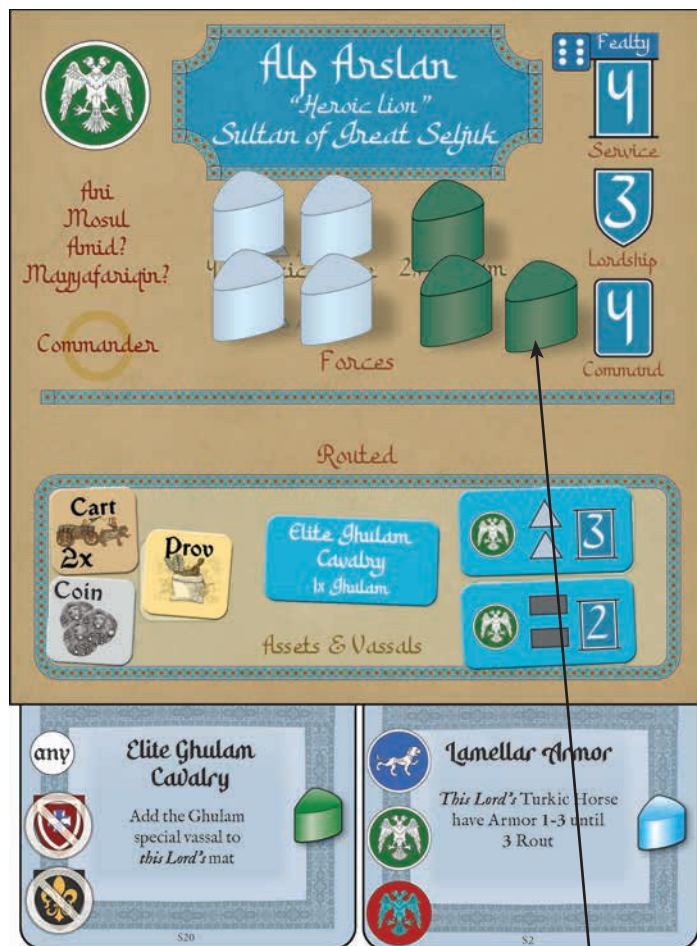
Muster



Beginning with the Seljuk player, each Unbesieged Lord at a friendly Locale on the map may now spend his Lordship to perform Levy actions. The Seljuk player begins with Ibn Khan. Ibn Khan spends the first of his two Levy actions to add a Capability card. The Seljuk player searches through the Seljuk Arts of War deck to pick out SUPPORT FROM ALEPPO, tucking it under Ibn Khan's mat. For their second Levy action, the Seljuk player decides to Levy a Transport and add a Cart so their army can carry more Provender; to do this, the Seljuk player flips the Cart marker in Ibn Khan's Asset box on his mat over to its ×2 side. After having completed all of Ibn Khan's Levy actions, the Seljuk player moves on to the next Lord.

Arisighi has a single point of Lordship, and the Seljuk player decides to use his Levy to add a Capability, choosing DEEP RAIDS and tucking it under his mat.

Finally, Alp Arslan has three Levy actions. For the first, Alp Arslan selects the Capability ELITE GHULAM CAVALRY from the Arts of War deck and tucks it under his mat. He also places the Ghulam special Vassal marker in his Assets section. For his second Levy action, Alp Arslan Musters the Ghulam special Vassal that is now on his mat, adding the appropriate unit piece (green wedge) to his Lord mat and flipping the Vassal marker face down. For his third Levy action, Alp Arslan adds a second Capability to his last available slot, tucking LAMELLAR ARMOR (S2) beneath his mat.



The two Arts of War cards at the bottom and this green wedge have just been added to Alp Arslan's Lord mat.

Now the Muster segment passes to the Roman player, who selects Romanos Diogenes to act first. Romanos has a Lordship rating of 3. With his first Levy action, Romanos attempts to Muster a ready Lord. Robert Crépin's cylinder is in the Spring 1068 box on the calendar, which is the current turn and thus means he is ready to be Mustered. Romanos rolls a d6 and rolls a 5, which is higher than Robert's Fealty rating of 4, so the Levy action is spent with no effect. Romanos spends his second Levy action to try again and rolls a d6 with a result of 2, which is less than or equal to Robert's Fealty of 4. The Roman player places Robert's cylinder on his Seat at Edessa and Robert's Service marker in the Autumn 1068 box, which is two boxes ahead on the calendar (equal to his Service rating of 2).



Robert Crépin is mustered and placed at his Seat.

Romanos then Musters the Hetaireia unit made available by the special Vassal marker gained from the SCHOLAI Capability earlier in the turn, adding the unit (white wedge) to the Forces section of his Lord mat.

If Romanos were located in the Roman Empire outside Constantinople, he could have instead used a Levy action to Muster an available Themata Service Marker from the Thema holding box of the Thema in which his cylinder was located.

Chatatourios in Antioch spends his Levy actions to add one Cart and Levy one of his Tagmata Vassals, adding one Tagmata unit (purple wedge) to his Forces and flipping the Vassal marker.

Finally, Nikephoros Bryennios adds the Capability BARDOUKIA and Levies his Vassal with two Tagmata units, Mustering the two Tagmata shown on the Vassal marker and placing the associated unit pieces in the Forces section on his mat, then flipping the Vassal marker over to its back side.

Note that Robert is not allowed to Muster this turn because he just entered the game during this Muster phase.

Call to Arms

Starting with the Seljuk player, both sides may execute one available Call to Arms action.



The Seljuk player has the option to use MARWANID ALLIANCE per the text of the card and does so, placing Alp Arslan's last Coin on the card. In future Call to Arms phases, they can instead use the Coin(s) already present to enact the card's effect per the text.

The Roman player elects to take one of the three Strategic Objective markers available to them from the supply, placing it in front of them for possible placement in a future turn's Call to Arms segment. Note here that the Romans can only claim a Strategic Objective or place one on the map that they have already claimed from a previous turn, but never both in the same turn's Call to Arms.

Campaign

Flip the Levy marker on the calendar to its Campaign side. If there were more of a player's "ALL" Capabilities tucked under the board edge than the number of Lords they had on the map, they would have to discard a number of "ALL" cards until the number they had tucked was equal to Lords on the map.



The Calendar shows Lords who will be ready to Muster on future turns.

Plan

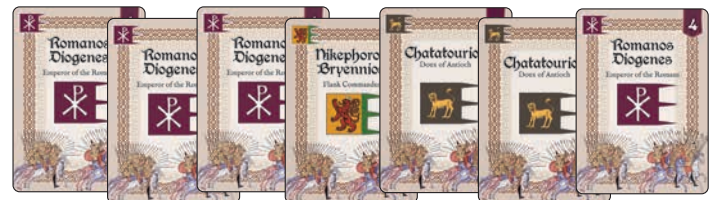
Now both sides simultaneously plan this season's Campaign by selecting a number of available Command cards and building a face-down deck based upon the season. On the Calendar, the Spring box indicates each player's Command Plan size, in this case seven cards.

Without showing the Roman player, the Seljuks select (from top to bottom): Arisighi, Arisighi, Arisighi, Arisighi, Ibn Khan, Alp Arslan, Alp Arslan.



Order of play, from top to bottom.

Meanwhile, the Romans have selected (from top to bottom): Romanos, Romanos, Romanos, Nikephoros, Chatatourios, Chatatourios, Romanos.

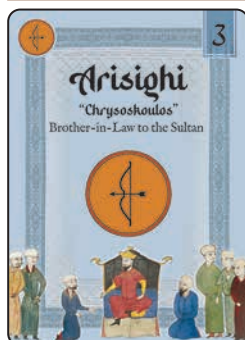


Order of play, from top to bottom.

Both players may also designate one Lord in a Locale with another Lord as a Lieutenant, stacking his cylinder on top of another Lord to show that the top Lord will be taking the bottom Lord with him via movement and combat for this entire turn. Neither can do so this turn; Romanos is a Commander and cannot be under a Lieutenant (and furthermore can March with Nikephoros as a Group anyway), and there are not two Seljuk Lords in the same Locale.

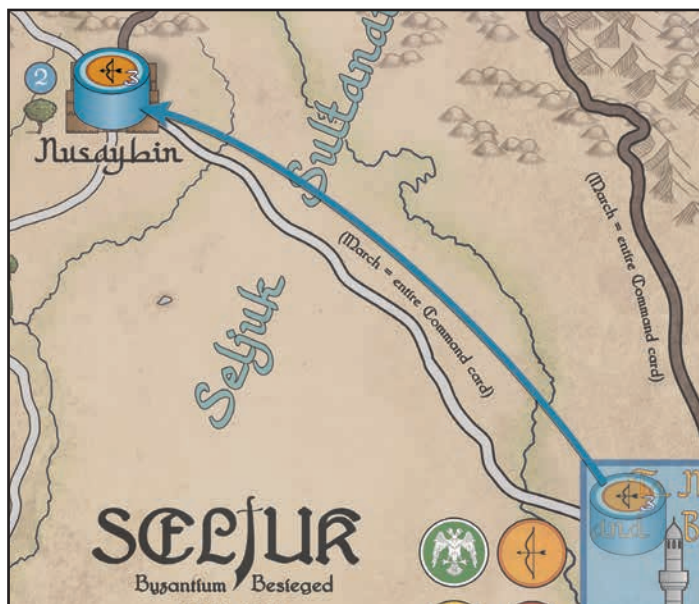
Command

Card 1

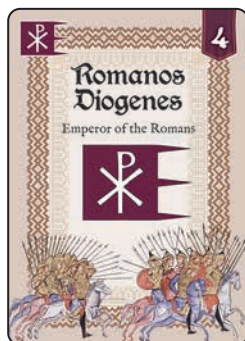


The Seljuk player acts first in each phase of the game, and so flips the top Command card from their deck, revealing it to be Arisighi. Arisighi has a Command value of three, which gives him three Command actions.

Arisighi Marches from the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box to Nusaybin. Because he is leaving a Holding Box, this March action takes up the entire Command card, even though Arisighi has 3 Command and his Forces contain only Turkic Horse units (which would normally give him a free March). The Seljuk player places a Moved/Fought marker near Arisighi's cylinder. After all the Lord's Command actions, and because he has moved, Arisighi must pay Provender to Feed his units. Arisighi has five units, so he consumes a single Provender token by discarding it back to the supply.



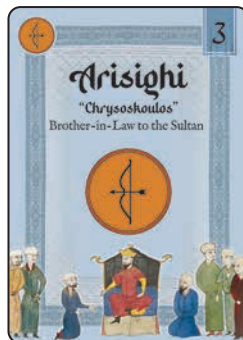
Arisighi uses a March Action.



Play passes to the Roman player, who flips their top Command card, revealing Romanos Diogenes. Romanos, like Arisighi, uses his entire Command card to March from the Constantinople box to Ankyra. Because Romanos is a Commander, he is able to bring other Lords at his Locale with him, and does so by moving with Nikephoros Bryennios and placing a Moved/Fought marker near them. Since both Lords moved, they both must

expend Provender. Each Lord has eight units or fewer in their Forces, and so they each must consume one Provender. If they are able to feed from their own mat, they must do that first, so both Romanos and Nikephoros decrease their Provender by one.

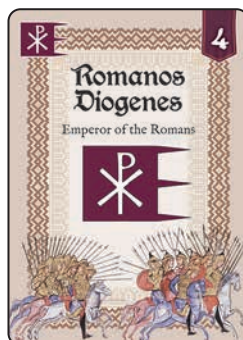
Card 2



Back to the Seljuks, and they flip their next card: Arisighi. Arisighi spends his first Command to perform a Supply action. Because he has one Cart and is only one Locale away from his Seat in Mosul, he is able to gain a Provender to the Assets box on his mat. For his second Command, he could take another Supply action, or he could perform a Forage. Because Nusaybin is a Friendly Stronghold, the Forage would automatically succeed. Either way, he adds a second Provender to his mat. For his third Command, he decides to March to Amid. Normally this would cost -1 Command because he has only Turkic Horse units in his Forces, and that reduces the first March of a Command card by 1 Command action; however, because he has more Provender than Carts, he is Laden and therefore the March costs him his third and final Command (1 for March, -1 for Turkic Horse special movement rule, +1 for Laden). After the March he consumes one Provender, reducing him to a single Provender Asset.



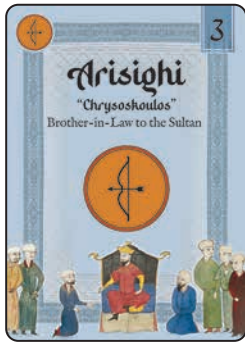
Arisighi uses another March Action.



The Romans go next by revealing Romanos Diogenes. He spends his first two Commands for Supply actions, adding two Provender to his mat, bringing his total to three. Normally he would be considered Laden since he only has two Carts, but because he is co-located with Nikephoros, they are allowed to share the total number of Carts between them for carrying Provender if they move together. Romanos then spends a Command to March to Charsianon accompanied by Nikephoros, and his fourth Command to March both cylinders again to Sebastia, marking them with a Moved/Fought marker. Even though they moved multiple Locales, Feed only requires a single instance of Provender expenditure per Lord during the Feed phase. Both Lords still have fewer than 8 units in their Forces, so they must each discard a Provender. Nikephoros is out of Provender, but he

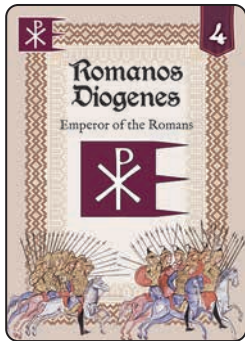
is allowed to Share with Romanos since they are co-located, so Romanos discards two Provender from his mat to pay the cost.

Card 3

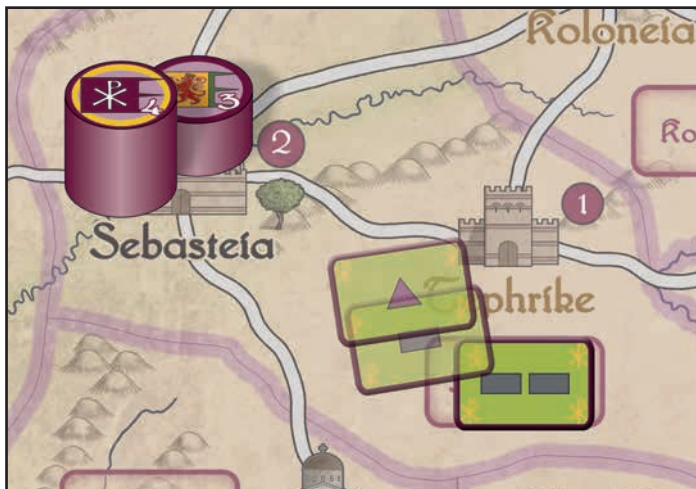


The Seljuk player reveals their third card: Arisighi. As previously mentioned, Arisighi's first March costs one less Command due to having only Turkic Horse units. Therefore, he Marches from Amid to Melitene for 1 Command action (1 for March, -1 for Turkic Horse special movement rule, +1 for Pass). Upon arriving in Melitene, Arisighi must either place a Siege or a Bypass marker.

As a 2-value Stronghold, Melitene requires two or more Lords to add additional Siege markers using the Siege action, so Arisighi decides to place a Bypass marker, which allows him to use his remaining two Commands. He wants to secure more Provender, but he is too far away from Mosul and Baghdad to use a Supply action; he only has a single Cart and it would require four Carts to trace back to his Seat from Melitene. Instead he decides to Forage, and because he is located at an enemy Stronghold, he must roll a 1-3 to successfully obtain more Provender. He rolls a 4 and fails. For his final Command, he tries again and rolls a 2, securing one Provender to his mat. He then consumes one Provender from his mat because he moved this Command card.

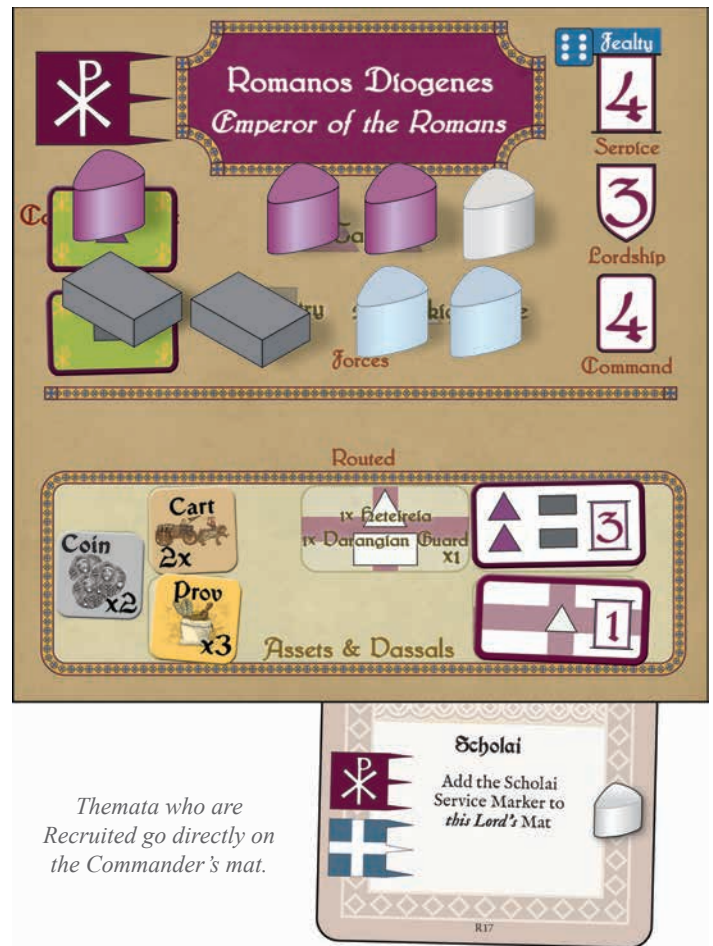


Back to the Romans, and Romanos is up again. Romanos utilizes his special ability as Roman Commander to take the Recruit action. For each Command spent on Recruit, Romanos can add one of the available Themata Service Markers in the Sebasteia box on the map to his Forces. He may only Recruit from Sebasteia because that is the Thema in which he is located. He elects to Recruit both the single Infantry marker and the single Tagmata marker, placing the depicted units in his mat's Forces area.

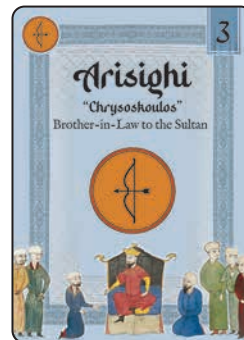


Two units are Recruited, removed from map and moved to Lord's mat.

For his third and fourth Commands, he takes the Supply action twice, adding two Provender to his mat.

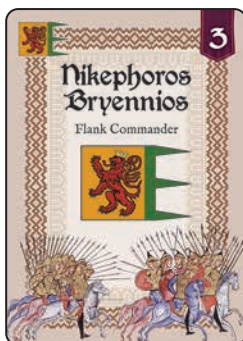


Card 4

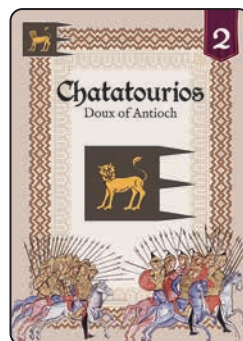


Arisighi goes once again and decides his first action will be a Ravage against Melitene. He has the option to spend a single Command or two Commands. If he spends a single Command, the Roman player has a chance to contest the Ravage with an available Themata marker. Not wanting to take the chance of failure, Arisighi elects to use both his Commands to Ravage, which allows him to place a Ravaged marker on Melitene and adjust his VP marker by $+\frac{1}{2}$ on the Calendar. He also takes one Provender from the supply and adds it to his mat.

Finally, because he Ravaged a Stronghold, he adds one Loot to his mat as well. This causes him to be Laden regardless of how much Provender he is carrying, which means Marching costs an additional Command. Even though he has only Turkic Horse and his first March would cost one less than normal, having Loot (and therefore being Laden) increases the cost to March by one, so he is not able to March east to Edessa, Amid, or Romanoupolis since they all cross a Pass and would cost an extra Command. He chooses to stay here and take the Pass Command action.

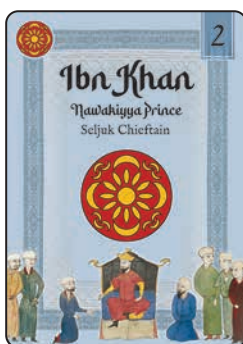


The Romans reveal Nikephoros for their fourth card. Nikephoros takes two Supply actions to gain two Provender and then moves to Larisa, after which he consumes a Provender.



Luckily the Romans' fifth card is Chatatourios and so they can respond. With two Commands, Chatatourios marches from Antioch to Artah, and then to Azaz, choosing to place a Siege marker on the Locale. He then consumes a Provender.

Card 5



The Seljuks reveal Ibn Khan, who with two Commands moves to Laodikeia, places a Bypass marker on the Locale and a Moved/Fought marker on his mat, and then Ravages. Because he only used one Command to Ravage, the Romans elect to try and defend with a Themata unit in the Antiocheia box on the map. They choose an Infantry unit and roll against the unit's Protection value found on the player aid card (Armored 1-3).

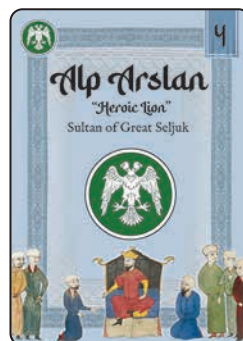


The Roman player can defend with any of the three Themata in the Antiocheia Thema.



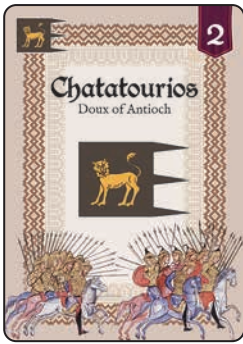
Arriving in Azaz, Chatatourios can either Siege or Bypass.

Card 6



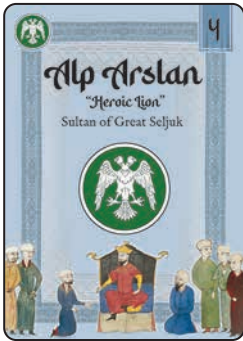
The Seljuks reveal Alp Arslan; he takes two Supply actions, gaining two Provender, which means he has more Provender than Carts. This makes him Laden, so when he then moves to Mempoet, it costs two Commands. He then eats a Provender when he is finished.

They roll a 4, which is a failure. The selected Themata unit is removed from play and placed off to the side of the map, and the Seljuk player places a Ravaged marker, gains a Loot and a Provender, and also +½ VP. Then Ibn Khan must Feed and so consumes a Provender.



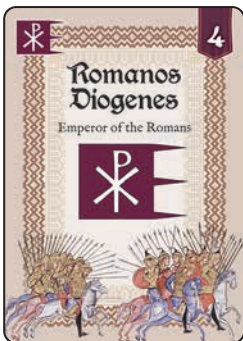
The Romans have Chatatourios activate again, and he decides to take two Supply actions to replenish his stores. Because he has two Carts, he is able to reach his Seat of Antioch and thus takes two Provender.

Card 7



The final Seljuk card revealed for the season is Alp Arslan, who now spends a Command to march to Theodosiopolis (which only costs a single Command as his Provender is now equal to his Carts and he is no longer Laden). He elects to place a Bypass marker and uses two Commands to Ravage the location, preventing the Romans from defending. This gives the Sultan one Loot, one Provender, and another $+\frac{1}{2}$ VP. With his

final Command, he does nothing, as he is already Laden. To Feed his army, he chooses to consume the Loot rather than the Provender as he has no plans of stopping at the border for the upcoming summer.



The final card revealed for the turn is Emperor Romanos. He marches Laden to join Nikephoros at Larisa, spending two Commands. Then, no longer Laden thanks to Nikephoros' Carts, he Marches again to confront Arisighi at Melitene, taking the trusted Nikephoros with him. The Seljuk player has to decide what to do about Arisighi, and seeing that he is vastly outnumbered, Arisighi chooses to Avoid Battle back to Amid.

Unfortunately, because Arisighi is Laden, he must drop all Assets that are causing his Laden status if he doesn't want to fight. Therefore, he loses his Loot which is claimed by the Romans and put on Nikephoros' mat. Romanos has one Command left, but without enough Carts for Supply and unwilling to abandon Melitene, he takes the Pass Command action. The Roman player must Feed both Romanos' and Nikephoros' troops, using one Provender and one Loot to do so. Romanos could not Forage because the Melitene Locale is currently Ravaged. Arisighi must also Feed because he moved via Avoid Battle so he also consumes a Provender.

End Campaign

With campaigning done for Spring, the game moves to the End Campaign phase. The game does not end because it is not the last Season of the scenario.

Growth

Next, because it is a Spring turn, both sides benefit from the Grow phase. Starting with the Seljuk player, each side reduces enemy Ravaged markers to half their total number (rounded up) on the map. The Romans have no Ravaged markers. The Romans can choose from the three eligible Seljuk markers (at Laodikeia, Melitene, and Theodosiopolis) and remove one of them (reduced to half their number rounded up means two are left on the map). The Romans choose to remove the one at Melitene and reduce Seljuk VPs by $\frac{1}{2}$.

Repairs

There are no Locales with three or more Siege markers, so the Repairs phase is skipped.

Wastage

During Wastage, each side must look at each of their Lords on the map. If that Lord has more than one of any kind of Asset (including Capabilities) they must discard an Asset of their choice. Alp Arslan has multiple Carts, Provender, and Capabilities, so he will suffer Wastage; he chooses to discard a Provender.

Alp Arslan could choose to discard any Asset or tucked Capability card during this Wastage.

Both Arisighi and Ibn Khan each have two Carts, so they must also suffer Wastage; they each decide to discard a Provender as well.

On the Roman side, Romanos, Nikephoros, and Chatatourios all have multiple Carts and/or Provender (and in Romanos' case, multiple Coins as well), so they all must discard something; they all choose Provender. Robert Crépin only has a single Cart and Provender, and thus does not have to undergo Wastage.

Reset

Romanos now must choose to pay for his Levied Themata Service Markers that he Recruited earlier in the turn if he wants to keep them with his army. For each Thema that has troops on Romanos' mat, the Emperor must spend one Coin or return them to the map. Because both current Themata are from Sebasteia, he can spend one Coin to keep them both, and does so. If he had chosen not to, they would return to the Sebasteia box on the map.

Both sides may then discard any Arts of War cards underneath their Lords' mats; neither side elects to do this.

Finally, if any Lieutenants were designated, they would now have their cylinders unstacked. Then, the Campaign marker is moved one Season forward on the Calendar and flipped to its Levy side.

Turn 2 – Arts of War (Events)

Both sides shuffle their Arts of War decks.

Now in Summer, the Seljuk player begins by drawing two Events from his deck. The first is SIEGE OF BARI, which allows the Seljuk player to remove from play two Themata Service Markers that are not currently on a Lord's mat. He chooses both the Tagmata and Infantry markers in Koloneia, placing them to the side of the map in the pool of removed from play Themata and paving the way for his advance in the north this turn. Because this event is marked with an asterisk indicating it can only happen once per game, the Seljuk player also finds the corresponding marker labeled "Siege of Bari" and places it on the Calendar in the current Season to show that it has occurred; future draws of this card will have an alternate effect (as stated on the Event).



Seljuk Art of War card
#5 SIEGE OF BARI



Seljuk Art of War card
#16 NORMAN EXTORTION

The second Seljuk card drawn is NORMAN EXTORTION, which will later in the turn cause a Loyalty Check against either Robert Crépin or Roussel de Bailleul, depending on which one is in play (see *Example of Play – Loyalty Check*).

The Romans then draw both of their Events; first they draw WINTER CAMPAIGN, which is a **HOLD** card. They do not reveal the text on the card and instead put it in their hand to be used at the appropriate time later in the game.



Roman Art of War card
#9 WINTER CAMPAIGN



Roman Art of War card #14
ALEPPO INDEPENDENCE

The second card is ALEPPO INDEPENDENCE. According to the text, because the city of Aleppo is not Conquered by the Seljuks (remember: Aleppo can never be Conquered by the Romans), the Event takes effect. The Roman player places the "Aleppo Independent" marker on the city as a reminder of the Event's restrictions. If Aleppo is Conquered by the Seljuks from this point until the end of the game, they will automatically win during the Winter phase if they control it (see 5.2).

From here, the game will continue as normal until one side or another achieves victory, or the scenario's final Season is completed. Let's examine a few other special sequences and situations that could occur in the game...

Example of Play: Loyalty Check

Extending into the Summer of 1068 turn, we will look at how the Seljuk Event NORMAN EXTORTION could play out.

During the Plan phase of the Campaign, when the Command decks are being assembled, the Event stipulated that the Seljuks must include their Treachery card in addition to the normal eight Command cards Summer requires. In order to keep the decks evenly sized, this also means the Roman player has to include one of their "No Command" cards.

Both players are free to put these respective cards in their deck in whichever order they want, but they must be included.

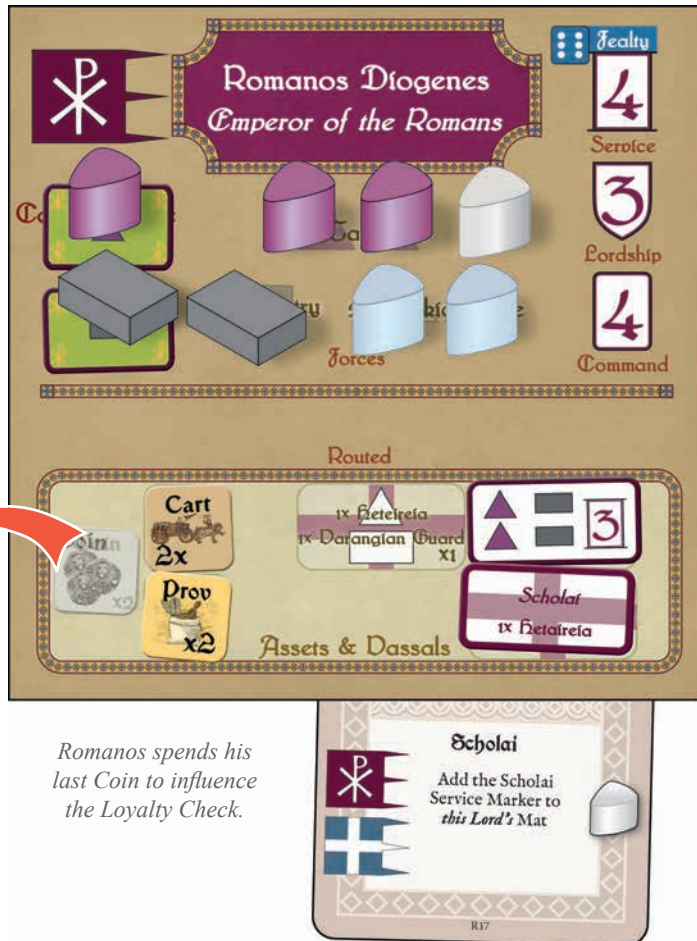
Moving into the Command phase, let's imagine the Seljuk player wants to strike immediately with their Treachery and see if they could swing Robert Crépin over to their cause.



Upon playing the Treachery card, the Seljuk player begins a Loyalty Check. First, they choose an eligible Lord (either Robert Crépin or Roussel de Bailleul as shown on the Treachery card and depending on one or both of them having a cylinder on the map; if neither do, then the Treachery has no effect).

In this example, Robert Crépin is chosen as the target. The Seljuk player will make a die roll, trying to roll higher than Robert's Fealty rating of 4, with a roll of 6 always being a success and a 1 always being a failure, regardless of modifiers.

Before that, however, the Seljuk player can spend Coin from Alp Arslan's mat to give themselves a +1 die roll modifier for each Coin spent. In our example, the Sultan has no available Coin and so passes.

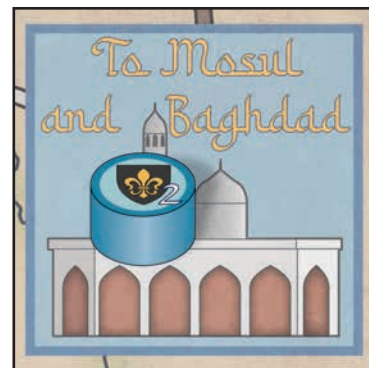


Next the Roman player has a chance to do the same from Romanos, albeit for a -1 die roll modifier. The Roman player decides to spend one Coin. Therefore, the Seljuk player must roll a 6 to succeed (normally a 5-6, but with a -1 from Romanos' Coin, and with a 6 always succeeding regardless of modifiers).

As luck would have it, the Seljuk player rolls a 6, and successfully converts Robert Crépin to the anti-Roman cause. First, the Seljuk player Disbands Robert, removing his cylinder and Service Marker from the map and Calendar, then discards all his current Assets and Forces from his mat, placing it to the side. Before the Pay step of the Levy phase of Autumn 1068, the Seljuk player will take Robert's mat with its starting Assets and Forces and place his blue Seljuk cylinder on the map at his Seat of Edessa.

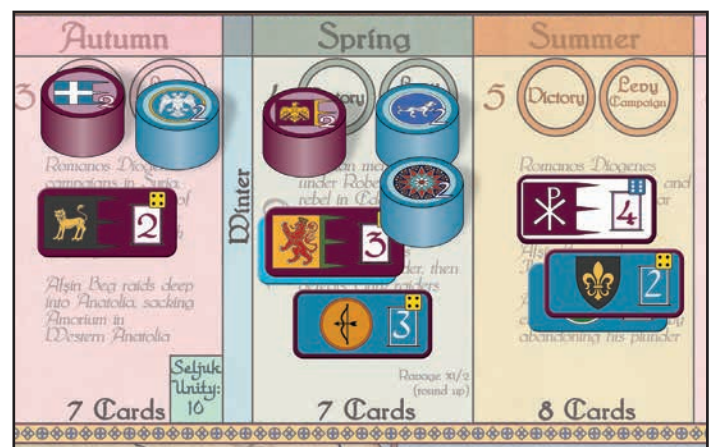


Robert switches sides and must remove all Assets and Forces from his mat.



If his Seat is occupied by a Roman Lord, then Robert's cylinder will be placed on the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box instead.

Then, Robert's blue Seljuk Service Marker will be placed according to its Service value as if he was just Mustered. Moving forward, the Seljuk player will have access to Robert's Seljuk Command cards during the Plan step if Robert is on the map.



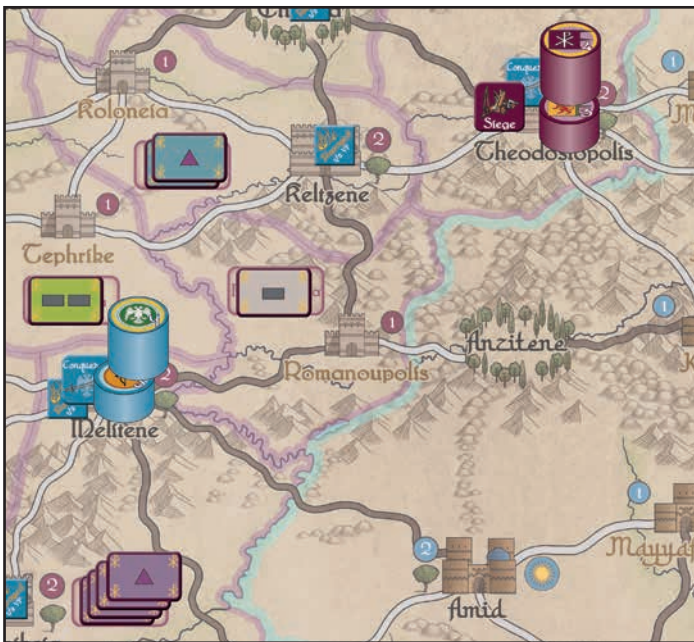
Robert's Service Marker is placed a number of turns ahead on the calendar equal to his Service rating (2).

Note that even if Robert Crépin is disbanded and no longer on the map, he remains Seljuk-aligned and can thus be returned to the game through a successful Fealty roll to Ready him during Muster.

Also note that some Arts of War Capabilities show Robert's (and Roussel's) heraldic symbol with a line through it; these Capabilities can never be added to these Lords regardless of which side they are aligned with.

Example of Play: Winter

It is Winter 1068. The Seljuk player has 4 Ravaged markers (Chaldia, Keltzene, Melitene, Germanikeia), a Ruins marker (Kaisareia), and a Conquered marker (Theodosiopolis) on the map.



Alp Arslan is at Melitene with three Loot, one Provender, and two Carts. Arisighi is also at Melitene with one Loot, no Provender, and no Carts. Afşin Beg is at Chaldia with four Provender, two Loot and two Carts. Romanos and Nikephoros Bryennios are at Theodosiopolis, which is Seljuk Conquered, but currently Besieged by the Romans. Nikephoros has the Capability FEALTY TO THE BASILEUS under his mat, one Cart and one Provender. Romanos has one Coin, two Provender, and two Carts.

The Capability MARWANID ALLIANCE is in play and was used during this Season's Call to Arms to make Amid a Seljuk Seat. The ALEPPO INDEPENDENCE Event has been revealed already.

Aleppo Conquered?

Aleppo Independent

ALEPPO INDEPENDENCE was played, so the city can serve as a Seljuk auto-victory, but it is currently not Conquered. The "Aleppo Independent" marker is present.

Bounty?



Every Seljuk Lord that can trace a path of Friendly, Bypassed, or Besieged enemy Locales back to his Seat can place into the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box a number of Loot from his mat up to the number of Carts he and co-located Lords possess, scoring 1 VP for each Loot so placed.

Alp Arslan and Arisighi are at the same Locale so they can Share their Carts. The Seljuk player decides to return two Loot: one from Alp Arslan and one from Arisighi's mat since together they have two Carts. Because MARWANID ALLIANCE allows Amid to count as a Seat during Bounty, both Alp Arslan and Arisighi can trace their path of Friendly, Bypassed, or Besieged Locales to Amid (though they could also successfully trace back to the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box if they wanted as well). The remaining two Loot with Alp Arslan must stay on his mat.

Afşin Beg has enough Carts to return his two Loot, but the path is blocked: Koloneia and Keltzene are Roman Friendly Locales, and Theodosiopolis is Seljuk Conquered but Besieged by the Romans. Therefore no Loot can be returned from Afşin Beg's mat.

The Seljuk player successfully returns two Loot, gaining +2 VP.

Seljuk Unity

Seljuk Unity in Winter 1068 is 10. The Seljuk player has six Locales under Conquered, Ruins, or Ravaged markers. They miss the goal by four, meaning they lose 4 VP. Because they scored +2 VP from returned Loot, the total VP loss this Winter is only -2 VP.

If the Seljuk player had 10 or more Locales under Conquered, Ruins, or Ravaged markers, they would lose 0 VP (but not gain VP for additional spaces beyond the 10).

Winter Quarters

Beginning with the Seljuks, each Lord must return to his Seat and discard any Assets causing him to be Laden. Arisighi returns to the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box. Alp Arslan can choose to return to Ani or the Mosul & Baghdad Holding Box; he chooses Ani, and must also discard the remaining Loot on his mat because they are making him Laden.

Afşin Beg can also choose to return to Ani or Mosul and Baghdad; he chooses Ani as well, but must discard both his Loot as well as two Provender because he only has two Carts.

The Romans then return Romanos to Constantinople. Nikephoros can choose to return as well, but because of FEALTY TO THE BASILEUS, he can choose to stay in the field Besieging Theodosiopolis, and does so.

Aleppo Diplomatic Maneuvering

Because the "Aleppo Independent" marker is on the map, one player rolls a die to see if the marker is removed. The roll is a 3, and it stays on the map another year.

Play then moves to the Levy phase of Spring 1069.

Example of Play: Storm

Alp Arslan and the Emir of Arran are at Theodosiopolis with their starting Forces, and both Themata Service Markers from the Iberia Thema are inside the Town. Theodosiopolis also has two Siege markers on it. Alp Arslan has the SHOCK TACTICS Capability under his mat, and both Seljuk Lords have one Provender in Assets.

After Alp Arslan reveals a Command card, he decides to spend a Command to Storm the Locale.

Array Lords

The Seljuk player places a single Active Attacking Lord in the Front Center of the Battle Array (in this case Alp Arslan, since he is the Lord whose Command card was revealed); Emir of Arran is placed in Reserve, and the two Siege markers are placed as Siegeworks on the attacking side of the Battle Array. The defender places four Walls markers to show the Walls value of Theodosiopolis is 4.



Concede/Reposition?

The defender cannot concede in a Storm, and the attacker is not allowed to do so until the second round (if there is one).

Strike/Hits/Protection/Rout

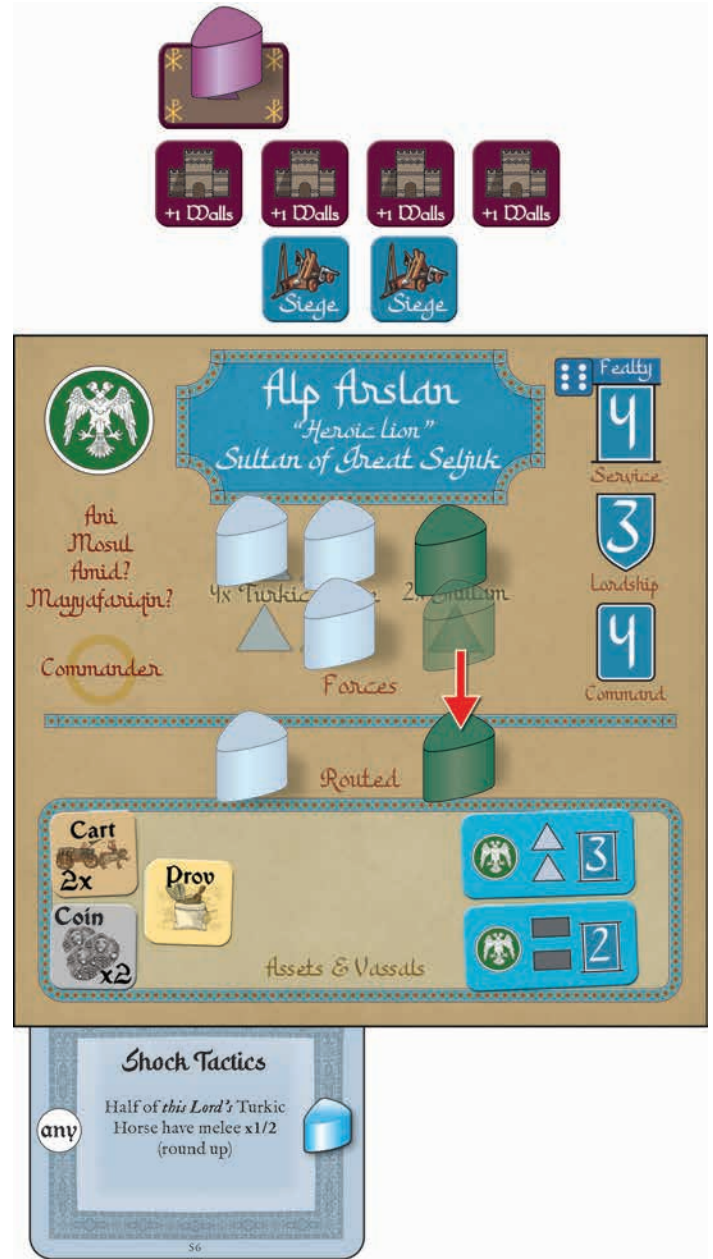
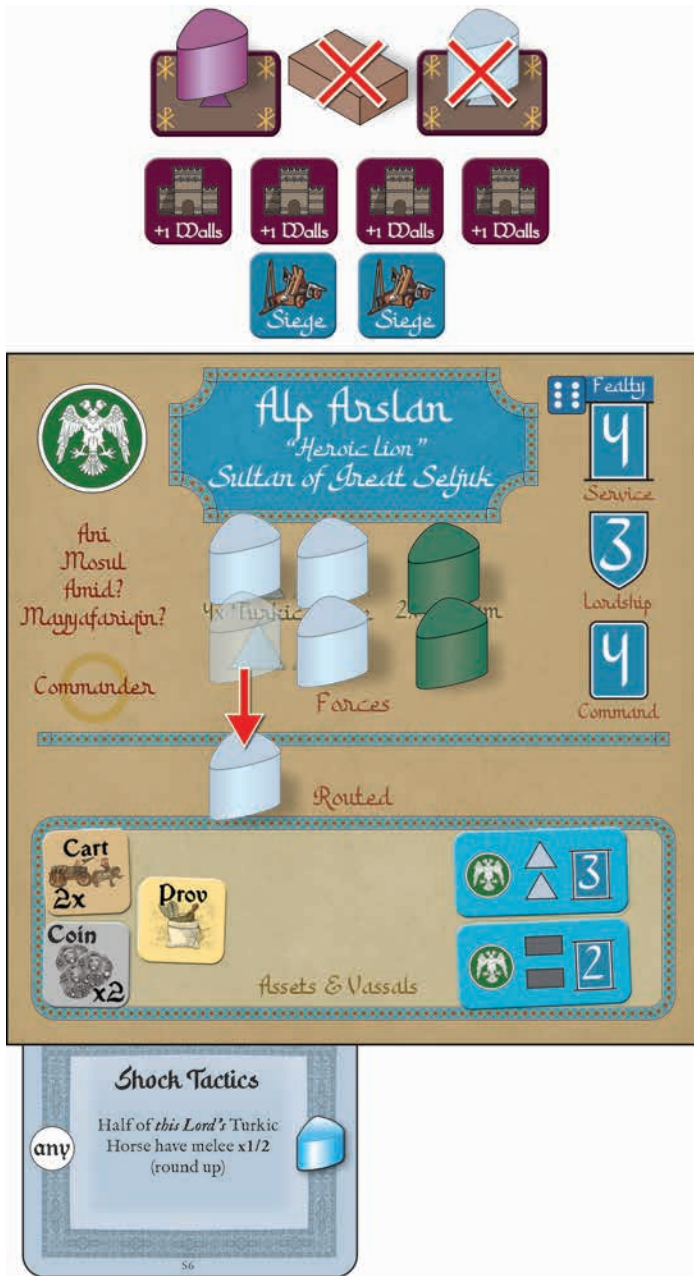
The Roman defenders count up their Missile Hits: the Tagmata is $\times\frac{1}{2}$, and the Turkic Horse is $\times 1$. The Militia unit normally does not have Missiles, but because it is a Garrison unit, it gains $\times\frac{1}{2}$ (as indicated on the Strongholds player aid card). The total is $\times 2$, and additionally, because the Garrison and Themata (as Garrison) units are defending in a Storm, they can choose their targets (as shown on the Strongholds player aid card).

The Romans choose to hit two of Alp Arslan's Turkic Horse units.

Alp Arslan first rolls two d6 for Siegeworks (the two Siege markers), getting a 1 and a 5 for a total of one hit getting through (the 5). He assigns the hit to the targeted Turkic Horse, who rolls for Protection (Unarmored, because Evade is only used in Battle during Melee). The roll is another 5, moving the Turkic Horse unit to the Routed section of Alp Arslan's mat.

Next the Seljuks count up their hits: three Turkic Horse each hit $\times 1$, and two Ghulam each do $\times\frac{1}{2}$, for a total of $\times 4$. The Roman player first rolls for Walls, consulting the die roll range on the Strongholds player aid card for a Town Locale (1-4). The Roman player rolls 2, 3, 6, 6 for a total of two hits getting through.

He assigns the first hit to the Militia unit, who rolls a 3 and is eliminated (he needed a 1). He assigns the second hit to the Turkic Horse, also needing a 1 (they are Unarmored and cannot use Evade in Storm), rolling a 2. The Turkic Horse Themata Service Marker is removed from play.



The Roman player then calculates for Melee, a $\times 1$ for Tagmata. The Seljuk player rolls to check Protection from Siegeworks (Siege markers) again, getting a 4, meaning the Hit gets through. This time, the Seljuk player can choose the target (and must select an Armored target if able because it is a Storm), and so assigns it to one of his armored Ghulam units with a Protection of 1-4. He rolls a 6, which moves the Ghulam to Routed.

The Seljuk player then counts up his hits: half (rounded up) of Alp Arslan's Turkic Horse have $\times \frac{1}{2}$ Hits due to SHOCK TACTICS, which is $\times 2$ in total (after rounding), along with $\times 1$ for the remaining Ghulam.

The Roman player rolls Walls and gets a 1, 1, 4 to cancel all three hits before they get to his lone defending Tagmata unit.

New Round?

Because there is a second Siege marker present and neither side has Routed the other, a second round of Storm begins.

Concede/Reposition?

The Seljuk player does not Concede. Because this is the second round, the Seljuk player can now move Emir of Arran from Reserve to either Left or Right on the Battle Array, and they do so, placing him on the Right.



A second Lord is allowed to join the second round of Storm because Theodosiopolis is a Size 2 Stronghold.

Strike/Hits/Protection/Route

The Roman player does $\times \frac{1}{2}$ Hits in Missile, which rounds up to $\times 1$. He chooses one of Emir of Arran's Turkic Horse. The Siegeworks (Siege marker) roll is a 2, meaning the Hit does not get through.

Next, the Seljuk player uses units from both Alp Arslan and Emir of Arran to generate Hits, a total of $\times 6$ (rounded up from $\times 5.5$).

Rolling for Walls, three of them are blocked. The other three make it through against the Tagmata unit defending the Locale. With a Protection value of 1-3, the Roman player rolls 1, 2, 5, which removes the Themata Service Marker from play and ends the Storm because the Roman player's Forces have been Routed.



The removal of the final Roman unit ends the Storm; the Themata are permanently removed from the game.

Retreat/Withdraw/Ruin

The victorious Seljuk player can choose to either Conquer the Locale, placing a Seljuk Conquered marker on the site, or can choose to Ruin it, placing a $+\frac{1}{2}$ VP Ruins marker on the Locale and taking Spoils.

Alp Arslan chooses to Ruin it and adjusts VPs accordingly.

Losses

Next, each Seljuk unit in the Routed section of its Lord mat rolls its Protection, which because this is a Storm, is automatically 1. Alp Arslan's Routed Turkic Horse unit rolls a 5, and is thus eliminated. The Ghulam, with a Protection of 1-4, nevertheless needs a 1 to recover since this is a Storm, not a Battle. The Ghulam rolls a 1 and is thus moved back up to the Forces section of Alp Arslan's mat.

Spoils

The Seljuk player consults the Strongholds player aid card and receives a Coin and two Provender; the Seljuk player decides to give the Coin and one Provender to Alp Arslan and the other Provender to Emir of Arran.

Aftermath

Alp Arslan and Emir of Arran are marked Moved/Fought, and the Siege markers at this location are removed from the Battle Array and/or map. Both Lords must now Feed/Pay/Disband, and so both consume a Provender from their mat.

Example of Play: Battle

The turn is Summer of 1070. Romanos' Service is in the Spring 1071 box. Nikephoros Bryennios' Service is in the Autumn 1070 box.

Romanos Diogenes and Nikephoros Bryennios are in Keltzene. Romanos has two Carts, three Provender, one Coin and his default starting Forces. Nikephoros has one Cart, one Provender, and his Infantry Vassal marker Levied in addition to his starting Forces.

Alp Arslan and Artuk Beg are at Theodosiopolis with a Bypass marker. Alp Arslan has two Carts, two Coins, and two Provender, his default starting Forces, and the Capability LAMELLAR ARMOR Levied. Artuk Beg has one Cart, one Provender, and his default Forces.



The Roman player has the **HOLD** card NOMADIC TRIBES GO ROGUE in their hand.

It is the Roman turn, and they use a March Command to move into Theodosiopolis. The Seljuk player chooses not to Avoid Battle, which causes a Battle.



Two Turkic Horse are removed before Battle because of the played Hold Event.

Array Lords/Play Event

The Romans place Romanos in the center and Nikephoros on the left. The Seljuks place Alp Arslan in the center and Artuk Beg on the right directly opposing Nikephoros.

The Romans play NOMADIC TRIBES GO ROGUE and eliminate two Turkic Horse from Alp Arslan's mat.

Concede/Reposition?

Neither side Concedes, and the Battle continues.

Strike/Hits/Protection/Rout

The Seljuk resolves Alp Arslan first, who does $\times 3$ Missile Hits to Romanos ($\times 1$ for each Turkic Horse and $\times \frac{1}{2}$ for each Ghulam). Romanos assigns the first to his Infantry and rolls Protection, needing a 1-3. He rolls a 1. For the second Hit he assigns it to the Infantry again, and rolls a 3. For the third Hit, he assigns it once again to the Infantry and rolls a 1.

Moving next to Artuk Beg, the Seljuk player does $\times 4$ Missile Hits. Nikephoros assigns the first two to his Infantry, one to each unit. He rolls a 4 and a 6 for Protection; each Infantry unit is Routed. The third Hit is assigned to the Tagmata unit, who rolls a 2. The final Hit is assigned again to the Tagmata, and it rolls a 6, Routing the unit.

Now the Roman player counts up Romanos' Missile Hits: $\times \frac{1}{2}$ for each Tagmata, and $\times 1$ for each Turkic Horse, for a total of 3. Alp Arslan assigns the first two Hits to his Ghulam units, whose Protection is a 1-4. He rolls a 2 and a 3, nullifying both Hits. For the third Hit, he assigns it again to one of his Ghulam, this time rolling a 6 in Protection and moving the unit to Routed.

Next, Nikephoros counts $\times 1$ Missile Hit against Artuk Beg from his lone Turkic Horse. Artuk assigns the hit to his own Turkic Horse, who must use their Unarmored Protection of 1 since these are Missile Hits. The Turkic Horse rolls a 4, which Routs it.



The result of Hits to each Lord from the Missile phase of combat.

Moving to the Horse phase of the melee step of Battle, Alp Arslan does $\times 1$ Hit in Melee from his Ghulam against Romanos. Romanos assigns the Hit to one of his Turkic Horse units, who can use their Evade Protection of 1-3 because this is a Melee Hit. Romanos rolls a 4, which fails and Routs the unit.

The defending Seljuks have no more Horse units that can Melee, so it passes to the attacking Romans.

Romanos does $\times 1$ Melee Hit for each Tagmata, for a total of 2. Alp Arslan chooses to take both Hits to his Turkic Horse; the first Protection roll is a 6, which Routs the defending unit. The next roll is a 2, which nullifies the Hit (thanks to LAMELLAR ARMOR).

Nikephoros has no more Horse units who can Melee.

The next step is Foot Melee. Alp Arslan has no Foot units. Artuk Beg still has his single Infantry, which does $\times 1$ Hit to Nikephoros. Nikephoros must assign it to his lone Turkic Horse using its Evade Protection rating. The die roll is a 5, which means Nikephoros has lost all his units and Routs. His mat is removed from the Array, and Artuk Beg is now Flanking Romanos.

New Round?

Both sides still have Lords on the Array and nobody Conceded the Field, so a new round of Battle begins.

Concede/Reposition?



This round, the Roman player sees which way the wind is blowing and decides to Concede the Field. They place the "Pursuit $\frac{1}{2}$ Hits" marker on the Array to show that they will only do $\times \frac{1}{2}$ Hits during each phase of Battle.

Strike/Hits/Protection/Rout

In the Defender Missile phase, because Artuk Beg is now Flanking Romanos, all the Seljuk Hits can be added together from both Lords.

There are a total of $\times 5$ Missile Hits (rounded up from $\times 4.5$) being inflicted by the Seljuks. Romanos assigns the first to his Infantry, who rolls a 3 and nullifies the Hit. The second Hit is also nullified by the Infantry with a roll of 1. The third Hit Routs the Infantry after it rolls a 4. The final two Hits are assigned to the Tagmata, and they roll a 2 and a 1 to nullify the Hits.

Romanos does $\times 2$ Hits in Missiles, halved to $\times 1$ because he Conceded the Field. The Seljuk player assigns the Hit to Alp Arslan's Ghulam, who rolls a 5 and is Routed.

In the Horse Melee phase, the Seljuk player no longer has Horse units who can Melee, and so it moves to the Attacker Horse Melee phase.

Romanos does $\times 2$ Hits, which is halved to $\times 1$ because he Conceded; it is assigned to Artuk Beg's Infantry, who rolls a 4 and is Routed.

Neither side has Foot units so Melee is skipped.

New Round?

The Battle is now over because Romanos Conceded the Field, and the Roman side is the loser.

Retreat/Withdraw/Ruin

The Romans must retreat back to Keltzene from where the attack was launched or they could choose to Withdraw inside Theodosiopolis, since it is Roman Friendly. Not wanting to be caught in a Siege, they retreat to Keltzene.

Losses

Both sides must roll to see if their Routed units are eliminated. Romanos rolls against the 1-3 Protection rating of his Infantry and gets a 1; the unit is moved back to Forces. He then rolls for his Turkic Horse, who is allowed to use his Evade Protection rating, and rolls a 5. The Turkic Horse is removed from Romanos' mat.

Nikephoros rolls a 6 for his Turkic Horse, a 2 for his Tagmata, and a 4 and a 5 for his Infantry, meaning only the Tagmata returns to his Forces.

During this same period, a political revolution engulfed Persia and Central Asia. Long used as fearsome mercenaries and elite guardsmen, the Turkic people of the Asian steppe served the Arab courts of the early medieval Muslim world. With their hands on the hilt of military might across generations, they established their own realms and power bases. By the late 10th Century, the Turkic Ghaznavid Empire ruled parts of modern-day Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan, and India. It would soon come face-to-face with a nomadic Oghuz Turk warlord named Seljuk in the early 1000s who threatened the pillars of its power. After the Battle of Dandanaqan in 1040, in which Seljuk's grandson Tughrul Beg defeated the Ghaznavids, the Seljuk Empire began in Khorasan, Iran. Over the next few decades, Tughrul would wage a grand campaign of conquest and political maneuvering, marching on the city of Baghdad, jewel in the crown of the Islamic world and seat of the Abbasid Caliph, its supreme religious authority. Sensing which way the wind was blowing, the Caliph proclaimed Tughrul Sultan. Thus, the reins of power in Transoxiana and Central Asia belonged to the Turks.

II. Upon the Throne (1064-1067 A.D.)

In 1063, Tughrul died and his nephew Alp Arslan seized an opportunity to succeed his uncle and claim the throne. By this time, the ambitious eyes of the Islamic world were turning west. An ideological conflict was brewing in the circles of the political elite between the predominantly Sunni Muslims of Persia and the Shi'a Muslims of the Fatimid Caliphate in Egypt. Alp Arslan's court wanted to establish dominance over his rivals in Cairo, and the political forces in the Sultanate began to muster toward the crossroads of Europe and Asia, with Constantinople caught in the middle.

Around this same time, Emperor Constantine X Doukas was in the midst of cascading strategic failure: the Normans were ravaging the last Roman possessions in southern Italy, threatening to seize the once-cultural heartland of the empire. Hungarian and Turkic invasions in the Balkans began to unravel Basil II's victories. And perhaps most significantly of all, in the face of these crises Constantine X made the decision to disband the empire's eastern frontier troops in Armenia, cutting the funding and manpower of the defensible mountainous regions of Anatolia. He raised taxes on the populace in order to hand out expensive court titles to bureaucratic officials in his political power base in Constantinople while attempting to refill the treasury.

In 1064, the repercussions of this decision were quick and immense: Alp Arslan seized Ani, the capital city of Roman Armenia, and sacked it viciously. The fabled City of a Thousand and One Churches burned and its citizens were packed off as slaves to Persia. Shortly afterward in 1067, old and infirm, Constantine died, with his final wish being that his wife Eudokia Makrembolitissa not remarry.

With the help of the Patriarch of Constantinople, the empress reigned for a few months while awaiting a successor to be chosen. But she had ideas of her own; seeing the failures of her husband and the ruinous precipice that awaited the empire, Eudokia hatched a plan to find a leader who could protect the

Queen of Cities from the depredations of the Turks. Time was of the essence: in the intervening months, the major Cappadokian city of Kaisareia was savagely destroyed by a Seljuk commander named Afşin Beg, a shocking echo of the fate of Ani three years prior.

Only six months after Constantine's death, the Empress married a popular and handsome Roman commander from Serdike (modern-day Sofia, Bulgaria) who had been convicted of attempting to usurp the throne after his distinguished service against the the Balkan Pechenegs raised his profile with the locals. Relieved of his house arrest, Romanos Diogenes was crowned on January 1, 1068 against the dying wishes of his predecessor and his predecessor's politically influential family. This specter of the Doukas clan would haunt Romanos for his entire reign, even as he employed his martial skill and charisma to quickly reform the Roman military and mount a defense against Turkic invasions.

III. Marching Across Anatolia (1068 A.D.)

Not long after being coronated, Romanos left on campaign in the spring of 1068. Assembling an army comprised of troops of various quality, the emperor marched from Constantinople to northern Syria in an attempt to recapture the recently lost town of Hieropolis (known as Manbij to the Muslims and strategic gateway to the fabled Roman city of Antioch). Throughout the summer he had to contend with Turkic raiding parties running rampant across central Anatolia; though he managed to chase them off from the fertile heartlands of the empire, he won no substantial victories. After seizing Manbij in the autumn, his troops ravaged the local lands toward Aleppo, but they were beaten back by Turkic warbands in the area. Realizing a defense at Manbij without available supplies or forage was futile, and learning that a raiding party under Afşin was returning from western Anatolia, Romanos struck camp and returned to more friendly territory to the north.

After wintering back at Constantinople, Romanos was determined to set out again in 1069. His troops had had some combat experience, and the enemies were many. However, before the campaign could get started, one of the Norman mercenaries in Roman employ gathered his troops in uprising. Robert Crépin, a veteran of the Spanish Reconquista and commander of a corps of troops stationed on the frontier at Edessa, was unhappy about the pay that he felt was owed to him and his men. After a heated disagreement with Roman authorities, an imperial force was sent to bring Robert to heel, whereupon he was arrested.

IV. Across the Mountains (1069 A.D.)

Having dealt with this internal threat, Romanos turned his attention to the east. Part of the emperor's long-term strategy was securing the mountain passes between Armenia and the highland border frontier around Lake Van. If the Romans could maintain a buffer state of Christian Armenian settlements, something they had done to great effect against the Arabs throughout the previous centuries, then they could make the Turks pay dearly for every raid.

To that end, the army of 1069 marched first to Melitene, an important military outpost and crossroads between the empire and its southern and eastern neighbors. Leaving the general Philaretos Brachamios as a rearguard, Romanos was able to drive off a Turkic force near Romanoupolis before moving against the fortress of Khliat near Lake Van. Unfortunately, a raid by Afşin Beg defeated Brachamios at Melitene, and then continued deep into the interior of Anatolia, sacking Ikonion and causing severe damage to Amorium and possibly Amaseia.

The emperor was forced to turn back from his goal to respond to these threats, and he sent word to Chatatourios, the Doux of Antioch, to intercept Afşin as the Seljuk lord returned home through Kilikia. Weighed down with plunder, Romanos hoped he could catch the Turks in a pincer movement between his local ally and his own army. Either Chatatourios was unable to oppose the Seljuk lord, or he did not get the message; Afşin slipped past the Romans and into Syria. Faced with Romanos' pursuing host, the Turks dropped their loot and managed to avoid direct conflict. The damage, however, was done: the terrible path of destruction wrought by Afşin left much of central Anatolia in ruin.

With no real victory to show for the campaign and his main objective for the year unrealized, Romanos returned to Constantinople in the autumn. Even without the Sultan in the field, the Romans had no answer to the slippery maneuvering of Seljuk forces.

V. Of the Sultan's Brothers (1070 A.D.)

While 1069 was frustrating the Roman emperor, Alp Arslan was dealing with his own problems. The Sultan's brother Qavurt was making moves to undermine Alp Arslan's authority back home in Iran, threatening the city of Isfahan and with it the political allies that kept the Seljuk Empire afloat. Qavurt was turned back by the Sultan but avoided serious reprisal. Familial conflict quelled for the moment, Alp Arslan prepared to aggressively march against the Romans and prevent them from establishing a foothold at Lake Van.

In the spring of 1070, Romanos delegated command of the Roman army to his ally Manuel Komnenos, the older brother of future Emperor Alexios Komnenos, while he dealt with the political situation in the capital. With Turkic forces besieging Manbij, Manuel split the army in two: one force was to march to Syria and relieve the siege, while the other was to rally at Sebasteia under his command. Manuel, however, unexpectedly met a band of troops under the command of the Turk Arisighi, Alp Arslan's brother-in-law. Though outnumbered, Arisighi defeated Manuel in the field and captured him. Then, in one of history's unexpected twists, Manuel convinced Arisighi to join him in returning to Constantinople and allying with the Romans.

There was bad blood between Arisighi and Alp Arslan, and possibly sensing an opportunity to better his own situation, Arisighi agreed. Upon learning of this news, the Sultan sent Afşin, who was fresh off a successful raid of Chonai, in pursuit. Afşin managed to catch up to the retreating duo at the Bosphorus but chose not to continue pursuit and instead returned east.

Manuel took Arisighi to Romanos, and the emperor bestowed upon him the title of proedros and a command in the imperial army, rewarding him for the knowledge of Seljuk battle tactics and strategic plans he brought with him.

VI. The Pivotal Build-up (1070-1071 A.D.)

Before 1070 was over, Romanos had ordered the construction of two mountain fortresses along the northeastern imperial border to stem the tide of Turkic raiding. In the meantime, Alp Arslan personally saw to the conquest of the forts at Manzikert and Arkesh, which the Romans had taken and garrisoned in previous years. With the lake area completely in Seljuk hands, Alp Arslan turned his gaze south to the lynchpin of the entire region: Aleppo. Taking the city could simultaneously cow the Fatimids and bottle up the Romans, allowing the Seljuks to impose their Sunni will on the surrounding territory. For Alp Arslan and his allies, their rival Muslims in Cairo were the real enemy; the Romans were simply a minor obstacle in their way.

First, however, the Sultan would have to take the fortified city of Edessa, then under the command of the Romans via their local commander Basil Alousianos. Assembling his host, Alp Arslan encircled the city late in the winter of 1070. Sensing that he would lose the city, Alousianos cut a deal with the Sultan: if he promised to spare the citizens the depredations of a sack and dismantle his siege equipment, the Romans would open the gates and turn over control of the city. Displaying the characteristic honor and nobility he was acclaimed for by his allies, Alp Arslan agreed. Once the siege equipment was destroyed, however, Alousianos reneged on the deal, and without the time or the ability to overcome Edessa's fortifications, the Sultan was forced to abandon his plan and move on.

Determined not to make the same mistake twice, he then arrived at the walls of Aleppo with a singular focus to take control of the city.

Meanwhile, Romanos was planning a campaign of his own, his largest endeavor yet. Over the previous 12 months, the emperor had enacted a series of reforms in the military to bring its troops and organization up to a higher standard that he hoped could contest the Turks. He also controversially debased the gold content of imperial coinage in order to pay for the army he planned to assemble. In the short term this would allow him to hire a large number of mercenaries to supplement standing imperial forces, but in the long term it would cause serious inflation in the Roman economy well into the 12th Century.

Romanos offered to exchange the city of Manbij for the recently captured forts at Manzikert and Arkesh in a bid to have the Sultan rein in Seljuk warbands from pillaging the empire. In reality, Alp Arslan had little control over the tribes from Central Asia that migrated westward, but they did provide a serious advantage to the Seljuks by hampering the Roman military and preventing offensive operations from entering Iran. If he tried to assert control over them, their vast animal herds would likely have eaten out the supplies of all the major cities that were home to the Seljuk nobility, and political strife would have found its way into the Muslim heartland.

As he marshaled soldiers from all corners of the empire, bad news arrived from Italy. The Adriatic city of Bari, the final Roman holding in Italy since Justinian's 6th Century reconquest, had fallen to the Normans. For three years the city had resisted the siege, but Romanos could only spare token reinforcements while he was dealing with threats from the east. Finally, out of patience and the will to fight, the city capitulated to Robert Guiscard, ending the Roman Empire on the peninsula for good. In the aftermath of Bari, Romanos' failure to negotiate with the Normans forced him to leave significant garrisons in the Balkans, stretching the imperial army thin across two continents.

While these pivotal events of 1070 and 1071 sent the great powers of Europe and Asia Minor into further conflict, a détente had settled in between the Sultan and the emperor. Envoys had been making their way back and forth between rulers, and a collaborative peace had been agreed to: if Alp Arslan could rein in his nomadic tribal allies whose loyalty he had earned through promises of Roman plunder and land, the Romans would step down their campaigning.

How much this supposed peace agreement between rulers achieved is unclear, but the raids continued into Roman territory regularly.

Now, at the start of 1071, with Alp Arslan mired in Syria, Romanos made up his mind and poured all his resources into a decisive campaign to the east. It was time to strike a blow against the Turks that they could not recover from.

Romanos assembled the largest Roman army seen in recent record. Mercenaries from Armenia and the Caucasus joined Kipchaks, Khazars, Turks, Alans, Persians, and other local peoples under the Roman banner. Romanos mustered the imperial tagmata in the capital, and enlarged his force with regional tagmata and other levies from central Anatolia while on the march. In addition, he was accompanied by his personal guard: the Varangians, the Hetaireia elite cavalry, the imperial Scholai, and a contingent of Norman knights under the command of Roussel de Bailleul. Somewhere between 30,000-50,000 soldiers turned out for the fateful march, trailed by a massive siege train Romanos had had constructed, and a vast war chest with which to pay for the expedition.

Little did Romanos know that it would be the last time he would leave Constantinople as Emperor of the Romans.

VII. All Roads Lead to Manzikert (Summer 1071 A.D.)

The emperor's route took him along the northern main roads to Kaisareia, Koloneia, and finally to Theodosiopolis, levying local manpower along the way. The march, however, was fraught with obstacles: the broken central pole of the imperial tent, a fire that consumed his roadside lodgings and destroyed many of his personal effects, and undisciplined German mercenaries pillaging local Roman towns (which caused a military standoff with the imperial forces as Romanos sought to punish them for their lack of discipline). His ally and friend Manuel Komnenos died suddenly from illness before summer. There were enough adverse incidents on the trek that Michael Attaleiates, the campaign's

military judge and one of the few contemporaneous accounts of the period, remarked that it seemed as though ill omens hung over the whole affair.

Romanos' march was not unobserved; Alp Arslan got word of the Roman movements toward his western borders, and he promptly struck camp and abandoned the siege of Aleppo, racing back to vassal territories in Azerbaijan to confront his Christian adversary. Along the way, his baggage train was washed away by swollen rivers in the Caucasus during a particularly hazardous crossing; as a result he was forced to stop and collect reinforcements and supplies from his Kurdish allies and those sent to him from Mosul and Baghdad.

At his base in Romanoupolis, Romanos instructed his men to gather supplies and prepare for a two-month campaign to finish the Turks for good. He split the army in two, sending half, including most of the light troops, under his commander Joseph Tarchaneiotes with instructions to head south to the fortress at Khliat and reconnoiter and secure the area. Among this detachment was Roussel de Bailleul and his Norman cavalry.

The other half of the army, commanded by the emperor himself and comprised of heavy cavalry and infantry ill-suited to combat against steppe warriors, headed east, easily conquering Mempat and then turning their attention toward the Seljuk garrison at Manzikert.

Unbeknownst to the emperor, Alp Arslan's army had made quick pace on the march over the summer months and was operating in the area as the Roman offensive toward Lake Van began. The Sultan, informed of Roussel and the detached portion of the Roman army heading to Khliat, promptly dispatched Sanduq al-Turki and as many as 10,000 horsemen to reinforce the garrison and confront the Roman cavalry.

It is unclear what happened when the two armies came into contact, whether there was a battle or if the Romans simply fled in disorganized fashion because they were caught by surprise. Regardless, Roussel and Tarchaneiotes ceded the field and, curiously, withdrew west to the safety of Melitene rather than back to the main army encampment at Manzikert. It is possible they expected to rejoin the main imperial force in short order. Based on the events that followed, it seems that word of this retreat did not reach the emperor, or if it did, it reached him too late.

VIII. The Final Battle (August 1071 A.D.)

While confusion reigned in the south, Romanos arrived at Manzikert and prepared a siege. The Seljuk garrison was tiny and was made up of both Muslims and local Armenians. After some saber-rattling between the two sides, and facing the Romans' significant siege weaponry, the garrison agreed to surrender on August 23, 1071, which was notably the exact same day that Roussel and Tarchaneiotes were routed near Khliat. The garrison, granted imperial protection, was allowed to leave the town in safety and the Romans assumed control of the walls and fortifications.

The next day, Romanos ordered Nikephoros Bryennios to support a foraging excursion around the town. Soon reports came in that the small Roman advance parties were coming under attack by mounted and well-organized Seljuk skirmishers and were forced to fall back. Surprised and unable to figure out where the Turks were coming from, Romanos called a council with his commanders to come up with a plan.

In fact, Alp Arslan's main force, up to 25,000 strong, had arrived in the neighborhood with good intelligence on Roman movements and operations and it was his vanguard that was harassing Bryennios' men.

The emperor, realizing he was facing a far larger enemy host than expected, ordered a recall of Tarchaneiotes and Roussel from Khliat, unaware they had been driven from the region. In the interim, the Seljuk commander Sanduq al-Turki's men clashed with mobile elements of the Roman army on the roads nearby and forced them bloodily back to camp. Bryennios himself returned wounded, his armor filled with arrow shafts and a spear he had taken to the chest, and with the dire information that Alp Arslan's full army was nearby.

As the gravity of the situation dawned on him, Romanos ordered the army into battle formation and began to advance toward Alp Arslan's camp in the east. Frustratingly, his troops were unable to make contact with the mounted Seljuk archers, who continued to fall back while peppering the Roman advance with arrows.

Eventually the Roman army came up against the craggy ground and difficult terrain of the area and was forced to turn back. That evening, more harassment skirmishing at the Roman camp caused panic and disorganization among the troops. A contingent of Oghuz Turkic mercenaries defected over to Alp Arslan, and by morning, the Sultan had moved his main encampment closer to the Romans, intent on avoiding a risky battle but seeking to project force to deter the Roman mission.

On Thursday April 25, messengers shuttled between the two camps, including Alp Arslan's loyal retainer Sav-Tekin, in an effort to broker a peace. The conditions laid out demanded that both armies strike their camps and return to their own territory. According to Muslim accounts, Romanos was eager for a fight and feared a return to Constantinople without a victory; he promised Alp Arslan he would march his forces through Iran before the year was out. He also humiliated the Seljuk envoys by forcing them to prostrate themselves before him.

While the Seljuk envoys returned to camp to decide what to do, Romanos sounded the order for battle, believing the attempt at peace indicated the Sultan was cowed and outnumbered. Both sides spent the moonless night preparing for battle, and in the morning, after crosses and religious icons were paraded before the assembled troops, Roman trumpets gave the command to advance.

The two rulers invoked the will of God as they donned their battle gear, with Alp Arslan famously (and perhaps apocryphally) donning an all-white set of garments over his armor and praying to Allah for victory. The Sultan gave tactical command to Sav-

Tekin, while on the Roman side, Romanos took command of the center, manned by the core of the army's elite imperial troops, while Nikephoros Bryennios commanded the left flank. In the rear, charged with guarding the baggage train and reserve, was Andronikos Doukas, political rival to Romanos and nephew to the previous emperor Constantine X. This decision would have far-reaching consequences for both the battle and the empire.

The actual numbers for each side are murky, but the Turks had somewhere between 12,000-20,000 on hand, and the Romans a bit more, perhaps as high as 30,000. This numerical disparity informed Seljuk tactics; for most of the day, Seljuk horsemen formed a wide crescent, setting traps and ambushes for Roman soldiers who strayed too far outside formation, rushing in and firing off volleys of arrows from the saddle before quickly retreating. The Romans were forced to endure this harassment for hours while trying to maintain an orderly advance.

The local terrain was broken, rocky ground made up of rolling hills and streambeds, and the fight was a mobile engagement, stretching over several kilometers with both armies vying for advantage, straining their command and control limits. As the Romans ambled ponderously, they overran a forward Seljuk command post. The Sultan's forces continued to skirmish and then swiftly withdraw.

Eventually, in the late afternoon, Romanos called for a halt. Both wings of the army had lost contact with the center, and his forces were fatigued after marching under continuous arrow fire. Fearing an attack on his distant camp and too far away to defend it, Romanos ordered the imperial standard reversed, the signaled order for withdrawal.

Whether he was confused by this display from afar (believing the emperor had fallen in battle), or had intended all along to betray his rival, Andronikos Doukas ordered his men to fall back from the battlefield, abandoning the forward lines to the enemy's mercy. Confused by the situation, nearby Roman units followed.

At that moment, sensing the enemy's confusion, Alp Arslan seized the initiative and sent his army into a charging counter-attack. The oncoming host smashed into the Roman right wing, separating it from Andronikos' withdrawing rearguard. The flank was dispatched and Seljuk warriors circled in behind the Roman center.

On the left, Bryennios also came under furious assault and attempted to ride to the emperor's support, but his forces were driven off and routed, leaving the main Roman infantry host encircled.

Romanos, realizing he was surrounded, braced his center for an attack from all sides, encouraging his men to stand fast and hack through the enemy.

Furious fighting around the emperor followed, with Romanos' horse being shot and injured, and the emperor taking a wound to his sword hand. The Varangian Guard were cut down, and the Scholai, a unit that traced its lineage back to Roman antiquity, were entirely wiped out as the Turks pressed their way into the throng.

As night fell over a battlefield piled with Roman corpses, a Seljuk ghulam was reported to have found the body of the emperor, injured but alive. Realizing who he was talking to, he brought Romanos immediately to Alp Arslan. Not only had the Seljuks won the day against Christendom's mightiest empire, they had captured its ruler in battle.

Casualties at Manzikert were relatively light outside the doomed center wing, with most troops having fled or been captured. But the impact of the Roman defeat would be felt through the following centuries. Never again would the Roman Empire field a central army as large as the one that marched to Manzikert in 1071. And though there would be several ebbs and flows of success and prosperity over the next 130 years, the Roman state would cease to be an offensive, imperial hegemony in Asia Minor, its role as a superpower whose legacy began with Constantine the Great ended.

IX. Aftermath (1071 A.D. and beyond)

The great tragedy for future generations was not that the Romans lost at Manzikert; for all intents and purposes, the Roman Empire was still able to recover from the defeat and reassemble an army. Instead, Romanos' defeat and the cynical political machinations of the Doukas family in Constantinople plunged the Romans into a decade of civil war and usurpations. This period of Roman versus Roman conflict drastically weakened the empire's defenses and allowed the Seljuks to permanently settle central Anatolia.

Romanos himself was treated gently and fairly by Alp Arslan, and within a week he had been released with his surviving entourage, agreeing to pay a huge ransom to the Sultan and hand over key Roman border forts to the Seljuks.

However, in the wake of the defeat, the Doukas family had acclaimed and raised Michael VII Doukas, the 21-year-old sheltered and inept son of the late Constantine X, as the new Roman Emperor. Now an enemy of the state, Romanos was forced to flee to his allies in Antioch and spend the summer gathering an army to defend his imperial claim by force. Marching across Anatolia, Romanos was defeated several times before being captured. He was taken before Michael VII, dressed down, forcibly blinded by hot pokers, and banished to a monastery for the rest of his days. The blinding procedure was not done well, and the wounds became infected. Denied medical care, Romanos died in exile in July of 1072.

The resulting instability in the realm opened the floodgates to the Romans' enemies. Turks swept over Asia Minor, taking control of formerly Roman towns and cities, and carving out petty kingdoms for themselves. In the span of a few years, Roman holdings in Asia Minor were confined to the coasts of the Mediterranean and Black Seas; the interior of Anatolia, the main recruiting ground for the Roman army, had been lost for good.

It wasn't just the Turks sensing opportunism. Roussel de Bailleul, the Norman mercenary who had marched to Manzikert under Roman banners, made his own claim by establishing a loyal court in Ankyra to control the city and its surrounding

lands. More incensed at this betrayal than of the sudden deluge of Turks, Michael VII sent several military expeditions to apprehend the treacherous Frank, all of which met with failure. Finally, in 1075, a young Alexios Komnenos was dispatched to try again, and working together with the Seljuk commander Artuk Beg, one of Alp Arslan's generals at the battle of Manzikert, they managed to capture the renegade and bring him to heel.

As for Alp Arslan, his triumph was short-lived. He returned a hero to Iran, which itself was on the verge of crisis as rebel factions across Transoxiana gathered to challenge the Sultan's power. In command of a large army, Alp Arslan marched to the banks of the Oxus, subduing rebel forts along the way; there he made preparations to advance to Samarkand. Taking prisoners after a battle against the hostile Kara-Khanids, the local rebel commander was brought before the Sultan and sentenced to death by archery firing squad. However, before the archers could loose, the prisoner grabbed a nearby knife and charged the Sultan, stabbing him three times. Alp Arslan died of his wounds on November 24, 1072, leaving the Seljuk Empire in the hands of his 18-year-old son Malik Shah and kickstarting a major civil war.

X. A Conclusion, a Prelude

As we know, the medieval Roman Empire would continue for nearly another 400 years, remaining the centerpiece of some of history's most important events. Manzikert was not the end, but it was *an* end. The empire of Constantine, Justinian, and Basil II had been irrevocably weakened, while the tide of Islam washed over central Asia and would only grow more wealthy, resplendent, and powerful in the centuries to follow.

Manzikert was also the catalyst for another event that would forever change the fate of distant Western Europe. In the years following the battle, the collapse of Roman authority in Anatolia and loss of its major cities to the Turks was of great concern to the world of Christendom.

After taking the imperial throne in 1081, Alexios Komnenos would bring about a generation of political stability and recovery in the Roman Empire, establishing a powerful dynasty with a singular focus on re-taking the cities and regions of the east that had been lost after Manzikert. He appealed to his political allies, his neighbors, and even the Papal authority in Italy (they were both Christians after all) for assistance, both diplomatic and military. But he likely never realized how his strategic maneuvering would lead to a vast foreign army showing up on the doorstep of Constantinople, claiming divine justice for the ancient religious sites of the Levant. Manzikert was, at the time, nothing more than an ignominious defeat in the history books to the Roman people, but as it turned out, it was also a match that lit the fires of Crusade.

Arts of War Cards

Roman Events



Events are on
top half of card

R1. FLOODED RIVER CROSSING*

Clarifications. The Seljuk player decides on the Wastage. If after executing a Wastage on Alp Arslan he does not qualify for further Wastage (because he only has 1 of each Asset or Capability), the Event effect ends. In other words, he will never be forced to remove an Asset if he only has a single Asset of each type or Capability card, even if there are additional Wastage instances remaining to resolve due to this card. When using the “if already marked” effect, the selected Lord must be one able to Muster this turn, if possible.

History. When Alp Arslan got word of Romanos’ march to Manzikert in the Spring of 1071, thus violating the “peace treaty” between the two, the Sultan undertook a rapid march from Syria back to friendly territory to gather reinforcements. Crossing incredibly swollen tributaries of the Euphrates River, the Turkish baggage train was swept away in the rushing snowmelt.

R2. MOUNTAIN AMBUSH

Clarifications. A Locale is adjacent to a Pass if one of its connected Ways is a Pass. Even though March from the map’s two holding boxes takes the entire card, they do not qualify as Pass.

History. Perfected against the Arabs after the rise of Islam, Roman military doctrine had for centuries been to allow invading armies to pass by fortifications and defensive positions, wait for their campaigns to become laden with loot and stolen goods, then emerge from the steep hills and ravines of Anatolia in surprise attacks to send enemy columns to flight.

R3. SUMMER HEAT

Clarifications. This effect takes place before any Command actions are performed after revealing the Command card. This card does not prevent Commands that cost an entire card like Tax, March from a holding box, etc.

History. The central and eastern highlands of Anatolia are an arid and remote geography, and campaigning in the high summer months was difficult without large logistical overhead for supplies.

R4. SULTAN’S HORSE IS KILLED

Clarifications. If used for the first effect of the Event, this card is played during Campaign when it is the Roman player’s turn. If using for the second effect, it is played during the Play Events step of Storm. For either choice, the card can only be played on a Locale that has more than 1 Siege marker where Alp Arslan is located.

History. During Alp Arslan’s siege of Aleppo in 1071, his horse was reportedly killed in a volley of defensive siege weaponry fire after he strayed too close to the city walls.

R5. FATIMID CONFLICT

Clarifications. This shift can be in any direction, Roman player’s choice.

History. Alp Arslan’s campaigns in Anatolia and Syria were mostly aimed at weakening the power and influence of the Fatimid Caliphate in Cairo, especially with regards to the city of Aleppo; armed encounters with the Roman Empire were a byproduct of this tension. This card implies that some of Alp Arslan’s lieutenants would be diverted to deal with his Shi’a opposition.

R6. MICHAEL ATTALEIATES

Clarifications. This card is played at any time during the Roman Muster phase.

History. Michael Attaleiates was Romanos’ military judge who was present on the 1071 Manzikert campaign. His written chronicle *The History*, which was commissioned by Romanos’ successor, is one of the few contemporaneous eyewitness accounts of what happened on the march and at the battle itself.

R7. BASIL ALOUSIANOS TRICKS THE SULTAN*

Clarifications. “Surrender on 3 or less” means the die roll needed to cause a Surrender (i.e., the Locale has some combination of 3 or more Siege and Ravaged markers). This Event cannot be played if there is a combination of four Siege + Ravaged markers at the Locale.

History. Basil Alousianos was the Roman commander (proedros) at Edessa. When Alp Arslan besieged the city in 1070/1071, Alousianos reportedly convinced the Sultan he would hand over the city if the Seljuk siege equipment was dismantled. Taking him at his word, Alp Arslan ordered their destruction, at which point Alousianos reneged on his deal and refused to open the gates.

R8. ROMAN PERSUASION

Clarifications. The Treachery card is in addition to the normal Command cards called for by the Season. If both players add their Treachery card in the same turn, both players also still add a No Command to the deck (meaning there will be two extra cards: the Treachery and a No Command) in each.

History. After a falling out with his brother-in-law Alp Arslan, Arisighi fled to the Roman Empire in 1070. He was confronted by Manuel Komnenos on the eastern frontier, but defeated the Roman general in battle. When brought before Arisighi in

defeat, Manuel convinced Arisighi to join him in returning to Constantinople and eventually fight on behalf of the Romans.

R9. WINTER CAMPAIGN

Clarifications. The Roman Lord may be Besieged. If both players play Winter Campaign/Winter March at the same time, the Seljuk player goes first, followed by the Roman player.

History. Just like summer, winter was a harsh season in Anatolia. The high elevation and arid climate meant campaigning was very difficult, and outside Alp Arslan's daring mountain march in late 1070 toward Edessa, the historical record indicates very little major activity in the cold months.

R10. AFŞIN MURDERS SELJUK OFFICER*

Clarifications. His Fealty will be considered 2 for all game effects. When using the "if already marked" effect, the selected Lord must be one able to Muster this turn, if possible.

History. Before Afşin Beg became the Sultan's notorious right hand, he murdered a fellow commander in a dispute. In punishment Alp Arslan had him exiled, at least until he was needed against the Romans.

R11. CHRYSOSKOULOS COUNSELS THE COURT

Clarifications. If the Seljuk player has no Hold cards, there is no effect.

History. Upon returning to Constantinople, Arisighi (known by the Romans as Chrysoskoulos) provided intelligence on Seljuk tactics and plans. He was rewarded with the title of Proedros (and later Strategos) in service of the Roman military.

R12. AFŞIN RECALLED

Clarifications. This shift can be in either direction, Roman player's choice.

History. In early 1068, Afşin was pardoned by the Sultan for the murder of a fellow commander the year before and employed in the raiding and ravaging of Anatolia, a skill which he refined with terrifying effectiveness over the following years.

R13. THRAKION REINFORCEMENTS

Clarifications. This returning Themata Service Marker must be placed in its Thema box, not on a Lord mat or inside a Besieged Stronghold. Players are advised to create a pile beside the board for Themata for game effects that remove or return them to play.

History. Romanos mustered the largest army the Roman Empire could field for the 1071 campaign, and that very likely included Thematic troops from the Balkans and its Thema of Thrace, both for the army but also to protect the borderlands from Seljuk raids.

R14. ALEPPO INDEPENDENCE

Clarifications. If Aleppo is already Conquered when this Event is revealed, the Event has no effect. In this instance, this Event does not trigger the ability for the Seljuk player to win the game during Winter for holding Aleppo.

History. Aleppo was a valuable lynchpin in the pan-Islamic conflict across the Middle East at this time. Its rulers were locked in a protracted civil war amongst themselves while also trying to play the Fatimids in the west against the Sunni Seljuks in the east in a bid to keep their nominal independence from both.

R15. EMIR OF ALEPPO SPURNS ALP ARSLAN*

Clarifications. If an Enemy (Seljuk) Lord is present in Aleppo when this Event is revealed, or Aleppo is Roman Conquered, it has no effect; instead discard and draw a new one. "If already present" means if the Independent Aleppo marker is already on the map. Once this Event occurs, either by placing the Independent Aleppo marker or causing Aleppo to become Roman Conquered, its once-per-game effect is considered triggered (mark the Calendar) and it cannot occur again.

History. Aleppo rejected overtures from the Sultan to convert to Sunni Islam and join the Seljuk camp, which prompted him to besiege the city in 1071. A few years thereafter, the rulers of the city appealed to Rome for help, a plea which found no sympathetic ears. This card provides for the possibility that, having been conquered by the Seljuks, the local nobles would cease fighting among themselves to throw off the Seljuk yoke, or having already rejected Seljuk dominion, aligned strategically with the Romans in fear of reprisal.

R16. ANGLO-SAXON EXILES

Clarifications. If neither of the two Varangian Guard are available (because both units are already with a Lord), or there are no Roman Lords who are not Robert or Roussel in play, this Event has no effect.

History. After the battles of Hastings and Stamford Bridge in 1066, some of the troops in the defeated armies of Harald Hardrada (himself a former Varangian Guardsman) and Harold Godwinson journeyed to Miklagard (Constantinople) to find their fortune in service to the Roman Emperor.

R17. UNPREDICTABLE WEATHER

Clarifications. The enemy player adding a No Command happens only if this event occurs in Summer.

History. The Taurus mountains of Kilikia rise up to 4,000 meters (over 13,000 feet), while the Caucasus range in Eastern Anatolia climbs even higher, up to 5,600 meters (over 18,000 feet). This rugged, unforgiving landscape of steep cliffs, long valley defiles, and dramatic elevations receives extreme weather. The vast quantities of snowmelt can have disastrous downstream effects at lower elevations during the shoulder seasons, all of which makes campaigning here difficult and dangerous.

R18. LOCAL SCOUTS

Clarifications. The other Enemy Lords not selected must follow through with the original Avoid Battle decision. Choosing Withdraw may only occur at a Friendly Stronghold (except a Friendly Aleppo). Resolve the Avoid Battle before Battle begins.

History. The theme system (themata) of the Roman military meant that all parts of the empire had commanders and troops with intrinsic knowledge of their local home areas, making

intelligence gathering and supply logistics easier for imperial forces marching through.

R19. RESILIENT AGRICULTURE

Clarifications. Only Seljuk Ravaged markers may be removed. The Roman player may not choose Ravaged markers in the Fatimid Caliphate. Remove as many as possible, and removal is mandatory.

History. Anatolia has always been a breadbasket region, home to a cornucopia of crops grown to feed empires. Be it the Persians, the Muslims, or the Turks on their doorsteps, Anatolian farmers knew how to squeeze the most from their land even when under imminent threat of raid or attack. This fertility of the land helped maintain key cities and military bases in unforgiving, remote locations for thousands of years.

R20. ARMENIAN RESISTANCE

Clarifications. If the chosen listed Locale has a Seljuk Lord present, the Seljuk player immediately places a Siege or Bypass marker there (Seljuk choice). If there is a Strategic Objective marker at this Locale, return it to available (do not place it in Constantinople as VP).

History. While many Armenians were resettled in Kilikia and central Anatolia prior to 1068, the country around Lake Van was still a heartland for the Armenian population of the Roman Empire. Matthew of Edessa chronicles at length the mistreatment of Armenians at the hands of both the Romans and Turks, but being Christians, they historically aligned more favorably with the Romans. This card allows for the possibility that the local population would organize to resist the Seljuks after they conquered these key border fortresses.

R21. NOMADIC TRIBES GO ROGUE

Clarifications. The removed units are eliminated immediately, with no roll to recover as after Battle. This event can affect a Besieged Lord, or a Lord not taking part in the Battle. This can occur to a Lord who only has two Turkic Horse units, thereby causing a Disband.

History. While many of the nomadic pagan tribes from the Central Asian steppe swore loyalty to Alp Arslan and the Seljuks, many others found their way into mercenary service with the Romans and other local powers due to their skill at mounted archery and tenacious fighting spirit.

R22. ASSASSINATION PLOT IN TYRE

Clarifications. Being 2 Locales away from Aleppo is considered “within” (for example, Manbij, Artah, Laodikeia, and Jazira). This shift can be in any direction, Roman player’s choice, and may cause Disband. Having only Turkic Horse does not help to be considered closer.

History. Ibn Khan almost exclusively made his career in Syria and the Levant. Unfortunately, he made a lot of enemies on both sides of the Aleppo civil war in his quest for power, and thus found himself exiled to Tyre and eventually killed by his own men in 1070.

R23. KLEISOURAI

Clarifications. The Seljuk player still gets to roll Protection for the unit assigned the Hit, but if the Protection roll fails, the unit is eliminated with no roll to recover as after a Battle.

History. Kleisourai in Greek meant both steep, narrow defiles in the landscape and also a category of light frontier troops who defended those defiles to ambush and harry invading armies while they were on the march.

R24. CAVALRY CHARGE

Clarifications. The Horse units that Melee Strike before Missiles skip their usual Melee Strike phase (after Missiles) that round. If this card is played at the same time as COMMAND CONFUSION, CAVALRY CHARGE takes precedence.

History. The famed Roman Kataphraktoi were the dominant heavy cavalry for centuries. Both men and horse were armored in expensive coats of metal, and a well-timed charge was a thundering hammer on the battlefield.

R25. HONORS OF WAR

Clarifications. The active Lord must still take a Siege action in order for this card to be played.

History. When the Roman army successfully took the fortress at Manzikert right before the battle, it was chronicled that the garrison gave up without a fight on the promise they would receive safe passage when leaving the town.

Roman Capabilities



Capabilities are on bottom half of card

R1. IMPERIAL FORTRESS CONSTRUCTION

Lord. Any

Clarifications. The Fort markers are placed when the Capability is Levied. The Lord does not have to be at the Locale in which he uses this card to place a Fort. A Seljuk Ruins marker is removed from the Locale when a Fort marker is placed (adjust VP). If both Fort markers are on the map, this Capability has no effect.

History. Sometime in late 1070, Romanos commissioned the construction of two forts along common Seljuk invasion routes from Ani. Where these specifically were is unknown, so the player has the choice of where they would like to place them.

R2. OGHUZ MERCENARIES**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. After spending the Lordship to Muster this Capability and place the special Vassal marker in the Assets section of his Lord mat, it takes an additional Lordship to then Muster the Vassal to the Lord's Forces and receive the unit. If this card is discarded, remove the Vassal Force(s).

History. The Oghuz were initially pagan Turkic people, most commonly from central Asia. The Romans employed them across the empire thanks to their fearlessness on horseback and skills with a bow. During the Battle of Manzikert, there was a large contingent of Oghuz mercenaries on the Roman side.

R3. STEELED RESOLVE**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. This effect applies to both Missile and Melee. Account for Hits from the JAVELINS Capability separately from Horse Missiles during Battle when using this Capability. Use the Capability's marker to indicate this card's effect.

History. In this era, Roman infantry were used mostly as an anchoring formation in the center of a battle. Cavalry tactics were the preferred method of waging war, so infantry usually had to face down enemy cavalry charges and harassing arrow fire while maintaining their discipline to not break or counter attack.

R4. PRESSED LEVY SERVICE**Lord.** ALL

Clarifications. The Lord may keep all Levied Themata Service Markers from the chosen Thema at no cost. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge. Use the Capability marker to indicate this card's effect.

History. Romanos called in all available levies to him on the march to Manzikert in 1071, including the regional themata of Koloneia, Charsianon, Chaldia, and Armeniakon, along the route to the town.

R5. NORMAN HEAVY CAVALRY**Lord.** Robert Crépin and Roussel de Bailleul

Clarifications. The reroll may be used on a different unit in Missiles and Melee. It is two rerolls: one during Missiles, and one during either Horse or Infantry Melee (not both).

History. Norman mounted battle tactics were extremely effective against light horse troops, something the Roman military was very aware of. The continued hiring of Norman mercenaries despite their dangerous shifting loyalties illustrates why they were so valuable against the empire's neighboring enemies.

R6. CENTRALIZED ADMINISTRATION**Lord.** Any, except Chatatourios, Robert Crépin, and Roussel de Bailleul

Clarifications. "Inside the Roman Empire" means beginning his activation at a Locale to the west of the border with the Sultanate, regardless of who controls that Locale. This +1 Com-

mand applies even if that Lord leaves the Roman Empire during his activation. Supply Routes are defined in 4.4.1.

History. The top-down, bureaucratic organization of the empire and its provinces allowed huge armies to efficiently march across Anatolia. Regional military bases and a vast network of logistics officials stretched from Constantinople to the border, providing commanders with the necessary support to wage war.

R7. EMPEROR'S RETINUE**Lord.** Romanos Diogenes

Clarifications. After spending the Lordship to Muster this Capability and place the special Vassal marker in the Assets section of his Lord mat, it takes an additional Lordship to then Muster the Vassal to the Lord's Forces and receive the units. If this card is discarded, remove the Vassal Force(s).

History. Hailing from northern Europe and Scandinavia, the Varangian Guard were famed for their battle prowess and complete loyalty to the Emperor. This service rewarded them handsomely in riches and prestige. The Hetaireia, meaning "the Company", were an elite corps of mostly cavalry that served as the Roman Emperor's personal bodyguard, primarily made up of foreign soldiers, including Franks, Magyars, Khazars, Arabs, and others.

R8. MARTIAL SOCIETY**Lord.** Robert Crépin and Roussel de Bailleul

Clarifications. This effect only lasts while the card is Mustered as a Capability.

History. Normandy was one of the most prodigious crucibles for producing capable military commanders and soldiers. Norman nobles were renowned for their battlefield valor and their zealotry in carving out their own petty realms far from home. Despite their questionable loyalties to those that hired them, they were especially effective warriors against the medieval armies of Islam, as the First Crusade would demonstrate.

R9. PROVINCIAL BUREAUCRACY**Lord.** Any Commander (Romanos Diogenes or Manuel Komnenos)

Clarifications. The Lord may Tax the same Locale a second time on a future Command card this Season, but if it is not his Seat, it will place a Ravaged marker.

History. There was perhaps no less likeable a person in the Roman Empire than the provincial tax collector. The efficiency with which these career civilian officials funneled vast quantities of money to Constantinople was usually only matched by their enthusiasm for graft and skimming a share off the top for themselves. This constant liquidity allowed the Emperors to spend lavishly on opulent buildings, massive armies, and personal prestige projects.

R10. RECONQUISTA & SICILIAN COMMANDERS**Lord.** Robert Crépin and Roussel de Bailleul

Clarifications. This effect only lasts while the card is Mustered as a Capability.

History. Robert Crépin was a veteran of the Spanish Reconquista, being one of the key leaders during the crusade of Barbastro in 1064. Roussel de Bailleul was a ruthless lieutenant of Roger de Hauteville in Sicily. The combined combat experience of these two men around Europe prior to 1068 allowed them to lead commands in key areas of the Roman Empire during the reign of Romanos Diogenes.

R11. KLIBANOPHOROI

Lord. Any

Clarifications. This effect only lasts while the card is Mustered as a Capability. Armor 1-4 is against both Missiles and Melee. This increased Protection is not used for Losses after Battle.

History. Klibanophoroi means “camp oven-bearers”. These heavily armored cavalry were some of the Romans’ elite mounted troops, capable of withstanding the enemy during a cavalry charge. Often armed with cavalry maces (bardoukion), they could have devastating impact on the battlefield. Manzikert was likely the last time they took the field.

R12. EMPRESS EUDOKIA MAKREMBOLITISSA

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. The Empress token begins play on this card when Mustered. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Empress Eudokia was married to both Emperor Constantine X Doukas and his successor Romanos Diogenes, the latter of whom she may have possibly been romantically involved with before his coronation. She also served as the Imperial Regent in 1067 while Constantine X was ailing, their son too young to rule. Along with her uncle Michael Keroularios, she was instrumental in the plan to place Romanos on the throne. Acutely aware of the inept military response to Seljuk aggression at the border, she arranged for Romanos, a capable and well-loved general who nevertheless had been accused of insurrection in Hungary, to become Roman Emperor and stop the Turkic threat. Her card represents the political maneuvering she employed in the capital to keep her husband in power and the realm functioning while he was on campaign.

R13. SYNDOSIS

Lord. Andronikos Doukas and Chatatourios

Clarifications. This effect only lasts while the card is Mustered as a Capability. Armor 1-2 is against both Missiles and Melee. This increased Protection is not used for Losses after Battle.

History. Syndosis was a system under Roman military organization where a given community was made responsible for the cost of outfitting and provisioning a soldier who was required to report for duty that either 1) could not afford it himself, or 2) could afford it but chose not to (in this case, instead of provisions, they could pay the army in cash the value of the required kit). In both cases, it sometimes fell to less well-off provincial communities to provide for the war effort when Thematic call-ups were enacted. This card reflects the communal gear that these lower-quality troops would receive under this system.

R14. IMPERIAL COFFERS

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. Any Roman Lord may be the one adjacent in order to discard this Capability for its effect. Discard this card after both players have drawn their Events in the Arts of War phase. Discard this card for its effect only after both players have resolved their Events. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Constantinople was one of the world’s richest cities at the time, and emperors made liberal use of the funds, especially in the 11th Century. Many treaties and diplomatic overtures were made with gifts (and oftentimes chests full of cash), alongside a strong belief that every man has a price.

R15. FEALTY TO THE BASILEUS

Lord. Any

Clarifications. The Lord may stay in his current Locale, even if Besieging a Stronghold. If he chooses to return, he may not return to another Lord’s Seat, another Locale, etc.

History. Treachery in the Roman army had its roots stretching back to antiquity, and frequently an emperor might find himself at the point of a sword from a trusted subordinate. This card allows a particularly trusted lieutenant to operate more independently, a move illustrated by Romanos making Manuel Komnenos the commander-in-chief of the army during 1070 while he attended to political matters in Constantinople.

R16. ARMENIAN GARRISONS

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. Read this literally: when generating Garrison units, receive the units from both sides of the Garrisons chart (e.g., If a Fort, receive 2 Militia and 1 Infantry). This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Armenian soldiers regularly served both Roman and Seljuk armies across Anatolia; it was a mostly Armenian garrison at Manzikert that surrendered the town to Romanos in August of 1071 days before the battle. Roman military strategy of the time was to build a buffer zone using the population of Imperial allies to protect the heartland against Seljuk incursion.

R17. SCHOLAI

Lord. Romanos Diogenes and Andronikos Doukas

Clarifications. After spending the Lordship to Muster this Capability and place the special Vassal marker in the Assets section of his Lord mat, it takes an additional Lordship to then Muster the Vassal to the Lord’s Forces and receive the unit. If this card is discarded, remove the Vassal Force(s).

History. The Scholai traced its origin to the cavalry arm of the Praetorian Guard of ancient Rome, earning its medieval-era name during the reign of Constantine the Great. In the 11th Century, they were a small regiment of elite cavalry that were based in Constantinople and served mostly a ceremonial role. They vanished from Roman history after the Battle of Manzikert, where they were most likely destroyed.

R18. ICON OF THE VIRGIN MARY**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. “Regardless of situation” means ignoring any penalties to Losses after Battle, the effects of other cards or whether or not the Lord discarding the Capability Conceded the Field or not. Use of this card always guarantees the Lord may roll against Routed units’ Protection.

History. The Virgin Mary is one of the enduring symbols of Constantinople, and in desperate times the clergy of the city would parade her icon through the streets to hearten the populace and provide morale to the army, as they did during the Avar siege of 626. She was also often invoked during pre-battle prayer by Roman soldiers. Given her special place in the culture and spirituality of medieval Rome, her inspiring presence provided a determination to succeed in times of crisis.

R19. NOMISMA DEBASED***Lord.** ALL

Clarifications. This Capability is special in that it can only be triggered once per game. The Roman player may pay none, some, or all of their Lords with Coin or Loot before discarding this card for its effect. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Sometime in 1069 or 1070, as part of the reforms of the Roman army, Romanos debased the value of the precious metals in Roman coinage in order to be able to pay for the campaign he had in mind for Manzikert and to shore up the empire’s manpower problems. The coins went from 87% gold and 11% silver to 70% gold and 25% silver. This move, also enacted by many of the other emperors in the 11th Century, would lead to widespread inflation and financial crisis that would not be fully fixed until the beginning of the 12th Century.

R20. SIEGE WEAPONRY**Lord.** Any, except Robert Crépin and Roussel de Bailleul

Clarifications. This effect only persists while the Lord is Unrouted; if he becomes Routed during the Storm, enemy Walls return to their normal value. This Capability is also in effect if the Lord is in Reserve.

History. When Romanos set out from Constantinople in the spring of 1071, his column included a massive siege train complete with mangonels and other powerful weapons with the intent of capturing the key forts around Lake Van in the east.

R21. BARDOUKIA**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. The recipient of BARDOUKIA attacks is advised to roll Protection against these hits separately from other hits during the same Melee step.

History. Famed weapon of Roman cavalry, the bardoukion was a mace used to cause blunt force damage to enemies armored in mail, lamellar, or other protection against cutting and stabbing weapons.

R22. CAVALRY SUPPLY LINE RAIDERS**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. Note that the second occurrence of Wastage caused by this card does not happen if after the first Wastage procedure, the enemy Lord does not qualify for triggering Wastage (i.e., they only have a single Asset of all types on their Lord mat). In the case of multiple adjacent Lords, the Roman player chooses which Lord suffers the Wastage.

History. Medieval campaign success was defined by logistical planning and execution, and it was no different in Anatolia. Both sides fielded significant cavalry forces that were skilled and efficient, and small skirmishes were much more common than open pitched battle. This card is intended to make players think twice about being in close contact with the enemy, especially if they are carrying a lot of Loot or have a large baggage train.

R23. ALAKATIA**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. The defender should roll the extra Hit from ALAKATIA separately in most cases since it has the same special anti-armor effect as Garrison Missiles. If during a subsequent round of the same Battle the Lord has less than 2 Unrouted Infantry, he does not strike with the extra Hit (i.e., the Capability does not take effect). A Lord with more than 2 Infantry does not generate extra Hits (e.g., 4 Infantry does not cause 2 Hits).

History. Alakatia were wagon-mounted anti-infantry artillery weapons that flung flaming stones into enemy battle formations. Because they needed to be towed and required a team of soldiers to use, they were also impractical and expensive and didn’t see wide deployment.

R24. MULES**Lord.** Any

Clarifications. This effect applies once each Command card. This effect does not occur for this Lord if stacked under a Lieutenant or being moved by a Commander as part of a Group March.

History. Given the rough terrain of eastern Anatolia and the gradual deterioration of Roman roads through the centuries, beasts of burden were required to transport army supplies outside of the well-traveled imperial core. They were made use of especially in the craggy areas on the way to Manzikert.

R25. PSILOI**Lord.** ALL

Clarifications. The effect of this card applies to all non-garrison Roman Militia in play (Roman Garrison militia already have Missile $\times \frac{1}{2}$ with -1 to Armor as default). This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Psiloi were archers in the Roman light infantry ranks. While not nearly as impactful as Seljuk archers, they nevertheless were brought on the Manzikert campaign. Most of the Psiloi at Manzikert were assigned to guard the Roman camp or were sent with the force ordered south to Khliat (which was subsequently defeated) before the battle.

Seljuk Events



Events are on top half of card

S1. SURPRISE

Clarifications. The Roman player still gets to place his Themata (if any) as normal before the Siege markers are placed.

History. Seljuk raiding parties could cover huge distances thanks to their speedy horses and their goal of pillaging (rather than conquest). Many times local communities were struck before there was time to notify the local Strategos in order to mount a defense.

S2. MOUNTAIN AMBUSH

Clarifications. A Locale is adjacent to a Pass if one of its connected Ways is a Pass. Even though March from the map's two holding boxes takes the entire card, they do not qualify as Pass.

History. The Romans weren't the only ones adept at using the terrain of Eastern Anatolia to their advantage. At Manzikert, the Seljuk army withdrew to the nearby hills and craggy surroundings in the face of Roman advance in order to slow down their enemy and eventually stage a counterattack on more favorable ground.

S3. THE BETRAYAL OF ANDRONIKOS DOUKAS*

Clarifications. The Roman Lord selected must be a Lord in the left, right, or center position of array, and he may rejoin the Battle in a subsequent round during Reposition. This Event can only occur once per game. Place the appropriate marker on the Calendar in the turn it is played. If the card is drawn as an Event in future turns, treat it as No Event and return it to the Arts of War deck.

History. Andronikos Doukas was the nephew of previous emperor Constantine X Doukas, and presumably joined Romanos on campaign to represent the Doukas clan as part of the feuding politics between the courtly families. After Romanos ordered a halt to the general advance at Manzikert, Andronikos either misunderstood or deliberately betrayed the emperor by striking his rearguard force and retreating from the field, returning to Constantinople as Romanos was captured in battle.

S4. SUMMER HEAT

Clarifications. This effect takes place before any Command actions are performed after revealing the Command card. This card does not prevent Commands that cost an entire card like Tax, March from a holding box, etc.

History. The central and eastern highlands of Anatolia are an incredibly arid and remote geography, and campaigning in the high summer months was difficult without large logistical overhead for supplies.

S5. SIEGE OF BARI*

Clarifications. Unlevied Themata are Unbesieged Themata Service Markers not currently located on the Roman Commander's mat or already removed from play.

History. Bari was the last Eastern Roman holding in Italy from Justinian's 6th Century reconquest. The Normans under Robert Guiscard were bent on conquering the southern peninsula for themselves, and as a result put the Adriatic city under siege on August 5, 1068. Only able to deliver token reinforcements from Constantinople, the Romans were able to hold on for nearly three years before finally surrendering in April of 1071 while Romanos was on his fateful march to Manzikert.

S6. COMMAND CONFUSION

Clarifications. In other words, in each phase of Battle (missile and then melee), the affected Lord does his Hits after the Seljuk player's Lord(s) regardless of who is defending or attacking. If this card is played at the same time as CAVALRY CHARGE, CAVALRY CHARGE takes precedence.

History. The Romans faced considerable difficulty in responding and adapting to Turkic battle tactics, illustrated at Manzikert where different wings of the army advanced at different rates and got separated from the main host, while the confusion over the emperor's status on the field led to rout.

S7. DESERTERS

Clarifications. Remove a Themata Service Marker from a border Thema (Iberia, Mesopotamia, Melitene, Antiocheia), not a levied Themata Service Marker on the Roman Commander's mat.

History. The eastern frontier of the Roman Empire was not very well organized or manned, especially after the 1053 reforms of Constantine IX Monomachos disbanded the Iberian Thema in the far northeastern corner of Anatolia, an act which opened up many undefended approaches for the Seljuks to exploit over the next several decades. Additionally, a new policy of allowing soldiers to commute their service if they gave direct cash payments to the state depleted the recruiting and garrisoning of the border.

S8. CALIPHATE MERCHANT FINANCING

Clarifications. This effect takes place immediately after the Event is revealed, and the chosen Lord may exchange none, some, or all of his Carts for an equal number of Coins. The chosen Seljuk Lord may only use this effect for his own Carts on his mat.

History. Thanks to the administrative talent and effort of Alp Arslan's Vizier Nizam al-Mulk, the Seljuk army was able to draw upon the vast wealth of their empire to fund their military activity, taxing the merchant class across Central Asia to provide supplies and equipment without having to rely on perpetual military tribute and conquest.

S9. ALP ARSLAN'S MOUSTACHE

Clarifications. This effect only applies to Alp Arslan, and not Lords co-located at his Locale.

History. There is a (possibly apocryphal and/or hagiographical) Muslim account of the Sultan, in which his moustache is said to have been so long and glorious that he was forced to tie it behind his head in a knot so that he could sight down his bow when hunting. Immediately upon discovering this story, there was no doubt it would appear in the game as an effect.

S10. EASTERN REBELLIONS DEFEATED

Clarifications. This card is played at any time during the Seljuk Muster phase.

History. In 1069, Alp Arslan himself spent a portion of the year personally campaigning in Iran after his brother Qavurt, the ruler of the city of Kerman, rose in rebellion and made a play for the Seljuk throne by threatening Alp Arslan's power base at Isfahan. Ultimately Qavurt was brought to heel, but would be a thorn in the side of the Seljuks for another half decade.

S11. NORMAN SCHEMING

Clarifications. If the Roman player has no Held cards, there is no effect.

History. The Norman mercenaries in the employ of the Romans viewed the empire as a land of opportunity and riches, and some of the commanders rose against the emperor hoping to carve out their own petty kingdoms, most notably Roussel de Bailleul in 1072. Their access to Roman military plans and fighting styles would lead to major Roman defeats even with inferior manpower on several occasions.

S12. DOUKAI COURT INTRIGUES

Clarifications. This shift can be in any direction, Seljuk player's choice.

History. The relatives of the late Emperor Constantine X Doukas viewed the accession of Romanos Diogenes as illegitimate and unfavorable to their hold on imperial power. They engaged in both subtle and active measures to weaken Romanos' control over the military and the throne, culminating with the defeat at Manzikert after Andronikos Doukas abandoned the battlefield.

S13. PEACE OFFERING

Clarifications. The Coin is paid immediately before undertaking one of the listed prohibited Command actions, but those Command actions may be taken at any point during the acting Lord's Command card. Lords Besieging a Locale may remain Besieging that Locale but cannot take the Siege Command unless a Coin is paid under normal payment rules (e.g., the Coin can be from the Besieging Lord or from Alp Arslan if he is Unbesieged and on the map).

History. After the initial battles between Romans and Seljuks in 1068, Alp Arslan and Romanos engaged in diplomatic efforts to reign in Seljuk raiding of Anatolia and end direct military conflict. Both rulers sent envoys and gifts back and forth, but Romanos' march to Lake Van in the spring of 1071 was perceived as a transgression of the peace agreements, leading to the battle of Manzikert.

S14. MANUEL KOMNENOS FALLS ILL

Clarifications. This shift can be in either direction, Seljuk player's choice.

History. Manuel Komnenos was one of Romanos' primary allies at court, earning himself the title of kouropalates (master of the imperial palace) and was the older brother of future emperor Alexios Komnenos. In 1070 he was made commander-in-chief of the Roman army while Romanos stayed in Constantinople, and in the spring of 1071 he was a commander in the army that began the march to Manzikert, but shortly fell ill and died of an infection en route.

S15. THEMATIC TROOPS DESERT

Clarifications. The Seljuk player chooses from among the Thematic Service Markers, either Levied to the Roman Commander's mat or Unlevied (even Besieged), to remove from play.

History. The continuous success of Seljuk raiding and campaigning took its toll across the empire, leading to commanders ignoring orders to engage the Turks on some occasions, while mercenary units were recorded to have left the army at critical moments before the Battle of Manzikert.

S16. NORMAN EXTORTION

Clarifications. The Treachery card is in addition to the normal Command cards called for by the Season. If both players add their Treachery card in the same turn, both players also still add a No Command to the deck (meaning there will be two extra cards: the Treachery and a No Command) in each. Only one Treachery Event can occur per Arts of War phase. If both are drawn, the second is considered No Event and does not occur.

History. The Norman mercenaries of the 11th Century Roman Empire were skilled in battle against steppe archery forces, but were notoriously disloyal. On three separate occasions, major Norman commanders revolted against the emperor over issues such as pay, and seized land control, causing the Romans to commit manpower and military resources in fighting their own supposed allied troops rather than the Turks.

S17. UNPREDICTABLE WEATHER

Clarifications. The enemy player adding a No Command happens only if this event occurs in Summer.

History. The Taurus mountains of Kilikia rise up to 4,000 meters (over 13,000 feet), while the Caucasus range in Eastern Anatolia climbs even higher, up to 5,600 meters (over 18,000 feet). This rugged, unforgiving landscape of steep cliffs, long valley defiles, and dramatic elevations receives extreme weather. The vast quantities of snowmelt can have disastrous downstream effects at lower elevations during the shoulder seasons, all of which makes campaigning here difficult and dangerous.

S18. WINTER MARCH

Clarifications. The Seljuk Lord may be Besieged. If both players play Winter Campaign/Winter March at the same time, the Seljuk player goes first followed by the Roman player.

History. Just like summer, winter was a harsh season in Anatolia. The high elevation and arid climate meant campaigning was very difficult, and outside Alp Arslan's daring mountain march in late 1070 toward Edessa, the historical record indicates very little major activity in the cold months.

S19. NORMAN PAY REVOLT

Clarifications. The Treachery card is in addition to the normal Command cards called for by the Season. If both players add their Treachery card in the same turn, both players also still add a No Command to the deck (meaning there will be two extra cards: the Treachery and a No Command) in each. Only one Treachery Event can occur per Arts of War phase. If both are drawn, the second is considered No Event and does not occur.

History. In 1069, the Norman mercenary commander in Edessa, Robert Crépin, instigated a rebellion over the wages owed to him and his troops. While it didn't come to open conflict, he was arrested and confined for a couple years before returning to imperial service.

S20. ALP ARSLAN CONSOLIDATES POWER

Clarifications. If there are no permanently disbanded Seljuk Lords, this Event has no effect.

History. Much of Alp Arslan's political and military power came from his association and authority with the nomadic, pastoral Turks living and operating outside the developed Abbasid Caliphate in Iran. Through savvy patronage and diplomatic maneuvering, these quasi-independent bands raided and wreaked havoc on the Sultan's enemies, including the Romans of Anatolia. In exchange for their service they were promised riches and pasturage for their vast herds. Failure to deliver opportunities would have caused chaos and diminished authority for the Sultan in the wider Seljuk world as the various pagan groups turned their nomadic migrations on the cities and people of Central Asia.

S21. COMMON CULTURAL CAUSE

Clarifications. The Active Lord may be Besieged. This can occur to a Lord who only has two Turkic Horse units, thereby causing a Disband.

History. On the eve of the battle at Manzikert, notable numbers of Oghuz (pagan) Turkic mercenaries deserted Romanos to go fight for Alp Arslan, casting doubt among the Roman army as to their remaining mercenaries' reliability.

S22. MASSACRE OF ORTHODOX CLERGY

Clarifications. The Loot may be obtained regardless of the Locale being Besieged.

History. Turkic raiding parties could be especially brutal in their predations, such as the sack of Kaisareia in which the population of the city was either killed or taken as slaves, and Christian Orthodox churches were prime locations for pillaging thanks to the valuables they contained.

S23. REINFORCEMENTS DENIED

Clarifications. This shift can be in either direction, Seljuk player's choice.

History. The Roman army was suffering from financial shortfalls when Romanos took the throne in 1068, and despite an effective series of reforms both to the troops and currency production, the Romans were still using vast quantities of foreign mercenaries for their regular troops. When the Italian city of Bari came under siege in 1068, Romanos could only send token support, and he had to conscript Thematic troops during his march to Manzikert. He was also in contentious political straits with capable military commanders such as Andronikos Doukas and John Doukas.

S24. BAD OMENS

Clarifications. This card must be played immediately after revealing a Seljuk Command card, before taking any Command actions.

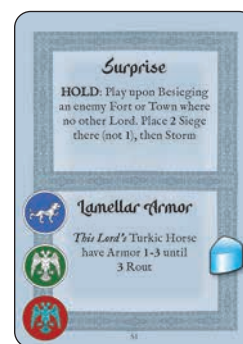
History. On the march to Manzikert, Michael Attaleiates chronicles several incidents that were taken as omens about the upcoming campaign, including a black dove flying into the hands of the emperor as they set sail across the Bosphorus, and a house fire that broke out in the building Romanos was staying in one night on the journey, which led to the loss of his horses and many valuable personal belongings.

S25. MERCENARY DISCIPLINE FALTERS

Clarifications. This includes all Roman Lords at a Ravaged Locale, both friendly and enemy Ravaged markers.

History. Michael Attaleiates recounts a moment on the march to Manzikert when some German mercenaries serving as the emperor's bodyguard began plundering and ravaging the local countryside for supplies. After Romanos delivered an exceptionally harsh punishment, the mercenaries and Romans confronted one another in full battle array outside camp before authority was restored.

Seljuk Capabilities



S1 & S2. LAMELLAR ARMOR

Lord. Emir of Arran, Alp Arslan, and Artuk Beg

Clarifications. Immediately upon 3 Turkic Horse units Routing from this Lord, the effect of the Capability no longer applies for the remainder of that Battle. If this Lord has less than 3 Turkic Horse units on their mat, this Capability will always be in effect.

History. Lamellar is body armor composed of layered square or rectangular plates stitched together. It was extremely prevalent in the Asian steppe and Asia Minor, with Turkic people particularly known for favoring it in battle. The Seljuk Sultan's central

military forces and those of his wealthy vassals would have been the best equipped forces on campaign.

S3. STEPPE RAIDERS

Lord. Sanduq al-Turki, Arisighi, and Ibn Khan

Clarifications. Adjacent includes across a Pass. These adjacent Ravages may be defended per the normal rules, depending on how many Command actions were spent.

History. The various warbands and steppe tribes that orbited the Seljuk empire were migratory pastoral nomads and extremely skilled on horseback. Their speed and archery talent allowed them to cover large distances quickly while wreaking havoc on settled areas, as exemplified by Afşin Beg's sack of the city of Ikonion deep into Anatolia in 1069.

S4 & S6. SHOCK TACTICS

Lord. Any

Clarifications. Because you round up when determining number of units, a single Turkic Horse unit will still strike at $x\frac{1}{2}$ and do 1 Hit with this Capability.

History. While not their preferred doctrine, some Seljuk cavalry had the ability to engage in melee combat if necessary, especially the Sultan's ghulam units. Heavily armored, they could strike a decisive blow on the battlefield.

S5. FORCED CONSCRIPTION

Lord. Sav-Tekin

Clarifications. This is in addition to his normal Muster actions using his Lordship. The recovered unit must be either one of his Levied Vassals or his original Forces.

History. Seljuk armies would often force the local population into military service regardless of ethnicity or religion, especially young boys. Sav-Tekin, a loyal retainer of Alp Arslan, also commanded the ghulam.

S7. TRUSTED COMMANDER

Lord. Emir of Arran, Artuk Beg, Sav-Tekin

Clarifications. This Capability does not confer the "Commander" icon or status as found on Alp Arslan's mat; it is for March only.

History. Among the nobles who fought with Alp Arslan at Manzikert, he chose his most capable and loyal vassals and courtiers to take the field, such as the Emir of Arran, head of the Shaddadid dynasty in the city of Ganja.

S8. MARWANID ALLIANCE

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. Use the Seljuk Seat markers on the map as a reminder of this process (3.5.1.1). This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. The Kurdish Marwanid dynasty of Diyarbakir enjoyed a golden age in the 11th Century, acting as an epicenter of learning and public works. Their alliance with the Turks resulted in great financial support from the Sunni Muslim world, allowing them to construct massive fortresses and bridges in their domain,

while the cities of Diyarbakir and Mayyafariqin were renowned sites of scientific education, especially in medicine.

S9. IMPERIAL RIVALRY

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. This attempt can come from any Lord's Lordship action as chosen by the Roman player in whatever order they choose. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. After Constantine X Doukas died in 1067, the Doukas family schemed politically to weaken Romanos' authority over the empire, viewing his rise to the throne over Michael VII Doukas as illegitimate. John Doukas, Michael VII's uncle, would eventually force Empress Eudokia into a convent after Romanos' capture, and was also responsible for the botched blinding of Diogenes in 1072. His son Andronikos, likely serving in the army as a foil to the emperor on campaign, deserted the battlefield at Manzikert, leaving the Romans to rout and the emperor to be captured by Alp Arslan.

S10. ARTUKID LEGACY

Lord. Artuk Beg

Clarifications. With this Capability, Artuk Beg may treat these two cities as Seats for Supply Route and returning Loot during Winter Bounty purposes for himself only, regardless of if MARWANID ALLIANCE is in effect. Loot from Bounty is placed in the Mosul and Baghdad Holding Box as normal.

History. Artuk Beg was one of Alp Arslan's commanders at Manzikert. He would later be hired by the Romans as a mercenary to capture the traitorous Norman Roussel de Bailleul. After his death, his sons founded the Artukid dynasty in his name in northern Syria and Iraq where they would go on to be nominally entangled with the events of the First Crusade.

S11. JAVELINS

Lord. Sav-Tekin and Emir of Arran

Clarifications. The player chooses which round of battle to use the Capability (use the Javelins marker to indicate when it's been spent). Javelins can be used in every Battle (but not Storm). Account for Hits from the JAVELINS Capability separately from Horse Missiles during Battle when STEELED RESOLVE Capability is present.

History. Both Roman and Seljuk light infantry used javelins in combat, but the Turks were specifically renowned for their skill and effectiveness with the weapon.

S12. THE SICKLE OF ANATOLIA

Lord. Afşin Beg

Clarifications. This effect lasts only while the card is levied. This card allows only one more Command action, not a Command Action that requires All plus an additional Command.

History. Afşin Beg was a notorious Seljuk commander responsible for the sack of multiple major Roman cities, including Kaisareia and Ikonion. His brutal methods and military effec-

tiveness earned him a reputation for ruthless violence. He was empowered by Alp Arslan to exert his will across Anatolia.

S13. GIFTS EXCHANGED

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. If the Seljuks choose to take a Coin, they must allow the Roman player to do the same; in this way each player can get at most 2 Coins from this card. Once it is empty of Coins, it stays in play until the end of the Season. Any Unbesieged Lord can receive the Coin. This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Efforts at diplomacy between the Romans and Seljuks resulted in opulent exchanges of gifts between emperor and Sultan on multiple occasions. The 1069 agreement of peace was undermined by frequent nomadic raiding campaigns by warbands affiliated with the Sultan but not totally under his control.

S14. SUPPORT FROM ALEPPO

Lord. Ibn Khan

Clarifications. Roll the die before taking any Command actions each time his Command card is revealed.

History. Aleppo was locked in a series of civil conflicts between the ruling families of the city in the mid-11th Century. Seeking to keep their neutrality, they played the Fatimids, Romans, and Seljuks against each other while they squabbled over nearby land in Syria. The city's Mirdasid emir Atiyya ibn Salih initially hired Ibn Khan to take control of the city, but quickly soured on the mercenary Turk as he grew in prominence in the local political scene, attacking him and causing him to switch allegiance to Atiyya's rival, Mahmud ibn Nasr. Mahmud and Ibn Khan then besieged Aleppo and took control of it before Mahmud also lost favor in Ibn Khan.

S15. NIZAM AL-MULK ADMINISTRATES THE SULTANATE

Lord. Any

Clarifications. The Lord may stay in his current Locale, even if Besieging a Stronghold. If he chooses to return, he may not return to another Lord's Seat, another Locale, etc.

History. Often credited with being the most important individual of the Seljuk era, Alp Arslan's vizier Nizam al-Mulk was extraordinarily skillful at administering state affairs while his liege was on campaign, establishing the madrasa system across the empire to establish a wide-ranging and influential educational network that would remain in use for centuries. His financial organization sustained the Seljuk war machine for decades, he served as mentor to Alp Arslan's son, and he authored a definitive treatise on Islamic society and jurisprudence.

S16. PARTHIAN SHOT

Lord. Any

Clarifications. This Capability does not apply in Storm.

History. The famed "Parthian Shot" was an archery technique whereby mounted horsemen would feign retreat in battle and ride away from an advancing enemy while turning in the saddle

to fire behind them. This hit-and-run tactic was the bane of many a Roman army from classic antiquity all the way through the Battle of Manzikert and beyond.

S17. DEEP RAIDS

Lord. Any

Clarifications. The Loot placed in the Mosul and Baghdad box reflects the VP earned from this card.

History. Seljuk raiding parties penetrated deep into the empire throughout the 11th Century, pillaging and sacking cities as far west as Kaisareia, Ikonion, and Chonai in Western Anatolia. Afşin Beg even pursued Arisighi on his way back to Constantinople all the way to the Bosphorus. The inability to defend these incursions led directly to Empress Eudokia's plan to put a seasoned commander on the imperial throne.

S18. UNSTOPPABLE TURKMEN

Lord. Any except Roussel de Bailleul or Robert Crépin

Clarifications. Laden March still costs the extra Command action. Battle still ends the Command card.

History. Turkic raiding parties could easily avoid fortified locations and defensive positions thanks to their use of fast horses and low logistical overhead. Due to their quickness, Roman armies tended to allow their enemies to pass by on approach and only face them in combat on their return journey after they were weighed down with loot and plunder.

S19. BAGHDAD REINFORCEMENTS

Lord. Any except Roussel de Bailleul or Robert Crépin

Clarifications. This restoration of a unit is free and does not cost a Lordship. The recovered unit must be either one of his Levied Vassals or his original Forces.

History. As the seat of Muslim power in Asia, Baghdad could supply huge resources and manpower for the Seljuks, and combined with Nizam al-Mulk's extraordinary administrative skill, fresh units from across the Sultanate were sent to Alp Arslan on his way to confront Romanos in 1071.

S20. ELITE GHULAM CAVALRY

Lord. Any except Roussel de Bailleul or Robert Crépin

Clarifications. After spending the Lordship to Muster this Capability and placing the special Vassal marker in the Assets section of his Lord mat, it takes an additional Lordship to then Muster the Vassal to the Lord's Forces and receive the unit.

History. Ghulams were slave soldiers, primarily non-Muslim boys captured from the Seljuks' enemies, who were raised as servants and elite warriors that owed loyalty to none except the Sultan and his dynasty. In battle, they frequently comprised heavily armored cavalry units, and it is reported that a ghulam was the soldier who discovered Emperor Romanos bloody and beaten on the battlefield at Manzikert.

S21. BRUTAL REPUTATION

Lord. Any

Clarifications. Only one single die may be rerolled. The new roll must be kept.

History. Several of Alp Arslan's Seljuk commanders would go on to make major names for themselves around the Middle East and Asia Minor after Manzikert. Some were feared for their ruthless plundering and sacking while others would earn esteem serving as mercenaries for the Romans in the civil wars that followed Romanos' defeat.

S22. TURKMEN SKIRMISHERS

Lord. Sanduq al-Turki, Arisighi, and Ibn Khan

Clarifications. Note that the second occurrence of Wastage does not happen if after the first Wastage procedure, the enemy Lord does not qualify for triggering Wastage (i.e., they only have a single Asset of all types on their Lord mat). In the case of multiple adjacent Lords, the Seljuk player chooses which Roman Lord suffers the Wastage.

History. The hit-and-run nature of Turkic battle tactics along with the depredations of settled areas and agricultural infrastructure made campaigning in Eastern Anatolia incredibly challenging. Planning for a season's march involved immense logistical burden not only from a materiel standpoint but also on the local friendly communities the Romans relied upon for supplies. Small units of Seljuk warbands could wreak havoc on an army's ability to operate.

S23. FORTIFIED GARRISONS

Lord. ALL

Clarifications. This effect applies during the Array Lords/Play Events step of Storm and only occurs once per Storm (not once per round). This Capability is not attached to any Lord and is placed at the board edge.

History. Strategically important conquests like Ani and the forts around Lake Van were vital to future campaigns. As such, the Seljuks left major garrisons at these locations to keep them in the Sultan's hands.

S24. PRISONERS

Lord. Any

Clarifications. A maximum of 1 excess Loot may be returned this way per Winter Bounty.

History. Seljuk raids took many prisoners and slaves in the wake of the sacking of Roman cities. The scale of the massacre and abduction of civilians is best exemplified by the Siege of Ani in 1064 and the destruction of Kaisareia in 1067.

S25. MULES

Lord. Any

Clarifications. This effect applies once each Command card. This effect does not occur for this Lord if stacked under a Lieutenant or being moved by a Commander as part of a Group March.

History. Alp Arslan's army in 1071, fresh off failed sieges of Edessa and Aleppo, had a large baggage train in tow. Given the nature of the poor roads and rough terrain around Armenia, beasts of burden would have been required to transport needed supplies and equipment through the narrow defiles of the Lesser Caucasus.



Designer Notes

In December of 2019, I received my copy of *Nevsky* from GMT Games. The *COIN* series was what got me into wargaming, and seeing that there was a first volume of a new series from *COIN*-creator Volko Ruhnke had me incredibly excited. On top of that, the game was about a rather obscure historical topic, and that always gets me interested.

Over the next few weeks, *Nevsky* was one of the final wargames I played in person for quite some time. My opponent and I got together for a handful of games, learning the ins and outs of the system, making critical mistakes, and having a lot of fun peeling back the innovative layers of what *Levy & Campaign* was presenting.

At the same time, I was voraciously listening to the terrific History of Byzantium podcast hosted by Robin Pierson. As I was driving to and from work listening to the incredible two-hour episode on the Battle of Manzikert in segments, Robin's pacing, presentation, and knack for making the narrative history come to life sparked my brain into activity. The events and details he recounted about the four years surrounding that fateful day in 1071 lined up perfectly with *Levy & Campaign*'s mechanical expression of theme. The concept for *SELJUK* sprang almost fully-formed into my mind.

I immediately got to work on a design document that contained all my thinking about how a campaign-level treatment of the Manzikert topic could be covered by Volko's series. In it was

a comprehensive timeline of events, *dramatis personae*, and ideations on the chrome that would evoke the specifics of 11th Century Anatolian military operations. Shortly before Christmas I emailed Volko, who I had met several years prior at GMT's Weekend at the Warehouse event while playing a game of *Wilderness War*. Figuring he got unsolicited game pitches all the time, I didn't expect a response or much consideration.

To my surprise, he responded immediately and was intrigued. He gave me a series of hugely helpful recommendations about how to conceptualize a design framework for the game and encouraged me to start exploring. Without realizing it, I had been set down the path of game design.

Fast-forward several weeks, and the world entered a pandemic shutdown. With most of my hobbies on hiatus, I suddenly had ample time to actually put in the work designing a wargame, something I had flirted with but never really pursued. I amassed a collection of books on the topic (which you can find in the following bibliography) and got to work puzzling out how to bring the idea to the table.

Over the course of the next 18 months, I put myself through what felt like an advanced college course on East Roman and Turkish medieval history, spent painstaking hours cross-referencing geographic information for the map, and hand-assembling a playable prototype.

Once it was in a playable state, I enlisted my friends to give this game idea I had a spin. Those first few plays were hilariously unbalanced and illuminated major faction parity and historical decision-making issues almost immediately. But the core engine powering the story of Emperor Romanos Diogenes and the Sultan Alp Arslan was producing historically accurate results on a consistent basis. I knew I was on the right track.

When GMT hosted the first post-pandemic Weekend at the Warehouse, I attended with prototype in tow and invited complete strangers to step into the shoes of the commanders. I also got a chance to meet with Gene Billingsley, Jason Carr, and other members of the GMT family. With Volko's continued support (for which I will always be grateful), *SELJUK* became a personal project with a path to publication.

Looking at *Levy & Campaign*, I wanted to evolve elements of the game system in a new direction, both to accurately reflect the setting, but also to provide innovation in the feel of gameplay. As a game player, I am a big believer in continuously-changing game states that are either totally or partially out of players' control, and that force them to react to unexpected developments on the fly. My favorite games all have an element of that. With the event cards in *Seljuk*, I endeavored to challenge both sides through their effects. I wanted both players to constantly feel like they could never be totally comfortable or predictive of the tempo of the campaigns, and for both sides to have unexpected SNAFUs, serendipity, and luck every time they played.

With that in mind, Christophe Correia and I also rounded out the Ravage mechanic found in other volumes. We wanted to make it more interactive and a tougher decision space for both the ravaging player and the player being ravaged. To that end, the

themata system interlocks nicely into the defensive side of the game, enabling the Roman player to provide some friction to the Seljuk player's asymmetric victory goals.

The other big consideration in the design was the asymmetry of forces. The Seljuks were not after a conquest of land in a military sense, and the Roman army was designed entirely to fight wars of conquest (offensively and defensively). The Turks relied heavily on their equine mobility, advanced archery ability, and hit-and-run battle tactics. The Romans, while also still emphasizing the power of cavalry in their military, were slower, outfitted with more heavily armored kit, and tended to have a more rigid tactical doctrine. I wanted this dichotomy represented strongly in-game; as the Seljuks, you will get free March commands with your Turkic Horse armies, and your archery will be extremely powerful in many situations. But after the missiles have been fired, superior armor and close quarters fighting will favor the Roman forces, so whichever player can exploit their battle strengths against their opponent will tend to be successful in combat.

With regards to the Roman Themata, it was also important that the provincial military forces of the day were represented since they played such a key role in security for the Roman east. Deployed as a network of defensive strongpoints across Anatolia, they are a versatile, if flimsy, tool for the Roman player to slow the advances of Seljuk armies. The Roman emperors had to make difficult financial and military decisions when it came to managing the Themata, and I wanted players to have to face the same dilemma. Stripping a Thema of its units can be powerful in the short term, but it also makes future Seljuk activities in those sectors much easier.

The political situation was also a facet of this conflict that deserved careful consideration. In reality, the Seljuks were not a monolithic army as we would recognize it; they were a cross-cultural mixture of pastoral nomads, vassal levies, and semi-professional military, all loosely allied but with varying degrees of interest and investment in the Sultan's success.

Modeling this politic was done mostly through the victory scoring via Seljuk Unity. Because the Sultan promised land and grazing territory for the more nomadic Turks in his domain, a failure to fulfill that promise would have resulted in a loss of standing, backlash, or simple fighting apathy from those cultural groups. This necessitated some sort of game mechanism to keep the Seljuk player pushing forward year after year to keep the Seljuk coalition together or risk losing the game. Taking some inspiration from Mark Herman's *Empire of the Sun* and its Progress of War track, I made the decision to hang a possible loss of VP over the Seljuk player's head if they were too conservative or took too much time dithering in their home areas.

From the beginning, the goal of designing *Seljuk* was that, even if nothing ever came of it, I would have a game about a topic near and dear to my heart that I could play with others. Byzantium as an entity is enjoying a bit of a resurgence in the western world right now, and beyond the treatments of its fall in 1453, there has been very little exploration of medieval Rome in gaming. I wanted to change that; there are countless events and stories between

the post-Justinian era and the final siege of Constantinople that would make amazing films or TV series, and if the history-enjoying, wargaming public just had some additional exposure, I felt confident they would also find enjoyment in them.

If even one person plays *Seljuk* and goes on to read more about medieval Rome, I will smile. There is a certain romance to the idea that Byzantium no longer exists, and the limits of our knowledge will always be constrained by what we unearth archaeologically or via historical texts. As a vanished empire, there is an allure of mystery that is unique to it; ruins, churches, frescoes, and mosaics are the fingerprints on the Earth that tell its story. And as a continuation of the Roman identity of the classical world, it offers a bridge from the first centuries A.D. to the modern day.

Seljuk is a project of personal passion as much as a project of history or game design, and I hope you find some enjoyment in marching your armies across the Anatolian plateau, assuming the roles of historical figures lost to time, and winning the day at the Battle of Manzikert (or wherever you choose to fight it).

Seljuk would not have been completed without the support of friends and colleagues who spent hours proof-reading material, playtesting, mentoring, and listening to me go on and on about Byzantine history for nearly four years. Bringing this game into the world could not have happened without you.

~ Justin Fassino



Developer Notes

After the work on *Levy & Campaign Volume III: Inferno*, a game which emphasizes the chaos specific to that setting, and *Volume IV: Plantagenet*, which is both a political and military tug-of-war, *Seljuk* brings the series back to the roots of the *Levy & Campaign* system found in *Volume I: Nevsky*. Supply is much more difficult and there is a higher importance given to ravaging and a relative ease in storming strongholds.

My development work started on *Seljuk* in early 2022 and it's been a real pleasure to work with Justin since then. While his design was already very solid from the beginning, there were some items that development helped refine as time went on and as the game's historical setting allowed.

Some development items that we tackled included improving player interaction even when they didn't have units in direct conflict. In a lot of *Levy & Campaign* titles, you sometimes

have the impression that the two powers stayed away and kept occupied by carrying out operations on their own. While those settings sometimes didn't allow for much interaction to stay true to their history, *Seljuk* allowed us to introduce more interactive systems, like the ability to try to block Ravage attempts through the use of Roman themata units.

The development process also allowed us to improve player agency when it came to the choices they could make as they get closer to victory. While the Seljuk ravaging is the core of the game (and you won't be able to win as the Turks without ravaging), you also have the choice to Storm Locales (and then Conquer or Ruin them), which takes longer and brings less VP, but is safer for your long-term ability to campaign closer to the Roman heartland in future years.

The Strategic Objective mechanic has also been introduced to incentivize the Roman player to do what was historically done: counterattack directly into Seljuk lands to force them into defending rather than using all their actions to Ravage. However, we wanted to avoid pure "design for effect", and while it can be very useful to use Strategic Objectives to get enough VP to counteract the Seljuk player's ravaging, other player-driven strategies like choosing effective Arts of War cards and putting strategic objectives on a Seljuk lord are good ways to make the Seljuk player more wary when he's trying to invade Roman territory.

An important part of the system's design is also the one-time event cards this game introduces, which replicate some historic events that occurred during the period; as those events can happen only once during the game, it gave us more leeway into how powerful those events could be, as no player could ever be crippled by having them occur multiple times within a scenario.

Finally, the Treachery mechanic included in the game, which is different but inspired by *Inferno*, allows the players to use Coin assets to incentivize some of the least loyal enemy Lords to join their side. To avoid much more rules overhead given the lesser importance of treachery in the overall design, the treachery system has been abstracted so that it's relatively simple while still justifying its inclusion.

All in all, the game has been developed towards both improving the overall flow of the actual gameplay, and giving more interaction and a feel of urgency to both players to focus on their objectives. If the game initially starts as a "get to the Seljuk unity threshold" rush for the Seljuk player, the dynamic of the game changes quickly year-by-year; the Romans get stronger and stronger as the game goes on, and the interplay between both sides' paths to victory will change. Each campaign year will feel like a new set of challenges where the players will need to think about how best to reach their goals which will often be different than those of the previous year.

I would like to thank everyone who participated in helping develop the game and those who are reading these lines, and I can only hope that you are going to have a great time playing this.

~ Christophe Correia



Artist Notes

It was great to work on another title in the *Levy & Campaign* series after getting the chance to contribute to *Inferno* and *Plantagenet* (as well as other GMT titles like *The British Way*). The artwork for *Seljuk* is a natural evolution from its predecessors. I kept a similar graphical and textual style but also attempted to evoke the medieval setting of both cultures through the typeface and image choices on the cards while also keeping the iconography as simple and legible as possible.

~ Matthew Wallhead (cards & player aid charts)

I love history. Drawing game boards, game material and maps for GMT Games therefore addresses not only my artistic skills, but also the lifelong addiction for fallen empires and ravaging wars. Sometimes I get jobs where the client has no material or the whole concept is poorly conceived and you discover those weaknesses during the creation process. This is often also a surprise for the client. But that was not the case with *Seljuk*; when I got the commission for this game, I also got a lot of material that had already been collected and prepared in a way that made it relatively easy to start with the job. It was a great project and I especially enjoyed drawing the map. The illustrations on the cards and screens were more of a challenge, so it was necessary to explore historic drawings to get the look of Seljuk and Roman soldiers right, but I think the results come very close to the original style. As with other commissions for GMT Games, this has been a real pleasure.

~ Robert Altbauer (map, pieces, screens, & card backs)

It was a real honour to be commissioned to create the cover art for *Seljuk*! Not just because I am interested in wargaming and strategy gaming, but also because this particular Byzantine setting has always held an allure for me, though admittedly I was not so familiar with the history in the century prior to the First Crusade. I had also not ever looked at the Battle of Manzikert in 1071 or figures such as Alp Arslan before, but was right away captivated by all the political and military maneuvering leading up to that battle. The diorama painting from the Istanbul Military Museum of the captured Diogenes was an obvious influence on the work, but I did not simply want to replicate that grand piece, and there are curious details in it, such as Diogenes' very classical-looking Roman armour. I created a few different concepts and presented those, among which the idea of Arslan surveying the landscape and the walls of Manzikert stood out as being more representative of the campaigning and operational scope of the game. I gave Arslan his commanding significance that was suggestive of operational concerns along with the caravan of various elements before him beside his retinue. To give some context to the actual battle at Manzikert, I also included the shield of a fallen Varangian guardsman on the ground.

~ Mitchell Nolte (cover)

CREDITS

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DEVELOPMENT: Christophe Correia

SERIES CREATOR: Volko Ruhnke

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PROOFING: Vedran Bileta, Joe Bottoms, Evan Davis, Hans Kortling, Bruce Mansfield, Peter Mojžiš, Blake Neff, Michael Neubauer, Brent Pollock, Marco Poutré, Arno Van de Velde, Jason Walonoski, Evan Yoak, and special thanks to all the rest of the *Levy & Campaign* Discord community who put eyes on the game over five years.

ART:

Robert Altbauer—Gameboard, counters, mats, screens, stickers.

Matthew Wallhead—Arts of War cards, Command cards, card backs, player aid charts.

Mitchell Nolte—Box cover

Charlie Kibler—Manuals

VASSAL MODULE: Christophe Correia

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Lords of the Campaign

Commander-in-Chief:

Romanos Diogenes



The Empress had freed this skilled commander from arrest so that, installed as Emperor, he might stop the Turks from destroying the Romans.

Vassals & Lieutenants:

Andronikos Doukas



He would command the reserve at Manzikert, but would his family's political rivalry with the new Emperor lead him to betray Romanos?

Joseph Tarchaneiotes



Second in command to Romanos, the defeat of his detached force pressing ahead to the fortress of Khliat would seal the main army's doom at Manzikert.

Nikephoros Bryennios



A keen military mind, he would command the left wing at Manzikert and, disillusioned afterward with a new Emperor, stake his own claim to the throne.

Manuel Komnenos



Older brother of future Emperor Alexios Komnenos and Roman army Commander in 1070, he would die suddenly of illness on the march to Manzikert.

Chatatourios



Armenian Dux of the City of Antioch and loyal ally to Romanos, he would side with the defeated Emperor in the civil war that followed Manzikert.

Robert Crépin



Norman mercenary and veteran of the Reconquista, now based at Edessa, the Romans would arrest him for his revolt over low pay.

Roussel de Bailleul



Another Norman mercenary and veteran of Robert Guiscard's Italian and Sicilian campaigns, he would serve at Manzikert before rebelling near Ankyra.



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Commander-in-Chief:

Alp Arslan



After consolidating the power of the Sunni Muslim world from Syria to China, his victory at Manzikert would open the gates of Asia Minor to the Turks.

Vassals & Lieutenants:

Afşin Beg



As Alp Arslan's brutal and effective right hand, he would lead numerous raids and sacks into Anatolia and pursue the defecting Arisighi all the way to Constantinople.

Arisighi



Alp Arslan's brother-in-law, he would fall out with the Sultan, best Manuel Komnenos in battle—then defect to the Romans and join the court at Constantinople.

Artuk Beg



A Seljuk commander, he would lead troops at Manzikert, then capture the rebel Roussel de Bailleul for the Romans, and position his sons to found the Artukid Dynasty in Anatolia.

Sav-Tekin



Commander and Seljuk nobleman who supported Alp Arslan, the chronicles would credit him with overseeing the ghulam elite heavy cavalry that seized Romanos at Manzikert.

Emir of Arran



Loyal vassal from the Azerbaijani city of Ganja, head of the Shaddadid Dynasty of Arran that would achieve its economic and military pinnacle in alliance with the Sultan.

Ibn Khan



First Turkic commander in Syria, a noble of the Nawakiyya steppe tribe of Oghuz Turks, he would become deeply involved in the civil wars between the Emirs of Aleppo.

Sandug al-Turki



Seljuk cavalry commander who harassed and ambushed the Romans during their advance toward Manzikert, scribes would credit him with routing Joseph and Roussel before the battle.